

MECCA AUDIO ENTERTAINMENT

A ROAR IN HARLEM

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Wainsworth Marcellus Hall / A roar in Harlem / Synopsis

Mike McCormick, a young boy by way of Kingston, Jamaica, was lost from his first few steps into the United States. Trying to find his way in a new land after being separated from his mother, "Trina," and left to survive with a judgmental and difficult father, his grandmother, and his older brother Ron, a Rastafarian connected to the "Cultures underworld." Many conflicting aspects has left young Mike confused as to what love is, after losing his mother, the only person who ever showed him any real love.

As time moved on, young Mike encounters a myriad cast of characters on his journey, leading him down a deeper and darker abyss. This would be the underworld of various ghetto's and tough neighborhoods from the mid-seventies to the early nineties, respectively. During his quest for survival and love, he becomes trapped within his own self-created prison, and forced to make ends meet by his wits. No wisdom or guidance from anyone in a positive light. He tries to balance the burning thirst to find his mother, with the burden of looking out for another older brother, "Kenny," who broke free from their father, "Chauncey," and his mother's treacherous grip, simultaneously.

This absence of love leaves Mike with an always suspecting and non-trusting nature, to the degree that everyone he meets, is on a timetable as to when they will cross him. When some love is shown or given, it is greeted by a shielded heart, convinced that it must be on guard at all times. Yet, within his mind there is an awareness that he can't quite identify, until one comes along who cannot be denied.

The walls of fear melt away, and he allows someone to touch. To reach in and caress the hardened soul he's carried for so long. Mike McCormick in the process, becomes more than a man. More than the feared street wise hustler he was known as. He transcends into what has eluded him for a lifetime.

He becomes a human being.

A roar in
Harlem By
Wainsworth Marcellus Unique Hall

FADE IN:

1. INT. (Presbyterian hospital – Waiting room – Early morning)
< Bloody, wild eyed, and delirious, thirteen year old Mike McCormack stumbles through the entrance doors. He resembles a victim in a horror movie. Thick puddles of blood are leaking inches beneath his heart. He staggers two steps forward. The waiting patients scramble in terror. His eyes retract, his legs stumble. >

FLASH BACK SERIES:

2. INT. (Beauty salon – Jamaica)
< Six year old Mike and his seven year old brother Kenny, are seriously waving toy pistols at the seated customers. The women are snickering and gesturing at the confident assailants. >
3. INT. (Spanish drug dealers apartment – Present day)
(MIKE)
Ahight, putas! You motherfuckers know what it is! Where the fuck is the dope?

< Mike has an automatic handgun aimed at the two terrified Spanish males. His partner, Bob, aims his revolver at the men. Mike leaves Bob in charge, as he struts over to the dining room table. The table is covered with stacks of money. He snatches off his jacket, removes the lining, and stuffs the money into the coat. >
4. INT. (Beauty salon)

< Mike and Kenny have their toy guns trained on the owner of the salon. She smiles admiringly down at the boys. Her customers continue to look on. >

(SALON OWNER)

We ain't got much of nothin' around here.

5. INT. (Spanish drug dealers apartment)

(#1 SPANISH MALE)

We got no coke, we got no coke!

< The prisoners are on their knees with their fingers locked on the top of their heads. Bob keeps them mesmerized with the barrel of his firearm. >

6. INT. (Beauty salon)

< The owner is stooped down in front of Mike. She presses a quarter down into his palm. Kenny keeps his gun trained on the customers. He peers over into Mike's hand. Mike stares gravely into her eyes. >

(MIKE)

Man, what in the hell we supposed to do with quarters?

< She hunches her shoulders and smiles. >

(SHOP OWNER)

I don't know.

7. INT. (Spanish drug dealers apartment)

(BOB)

Fuck it. We got more than we expected, son. Let's roll!

< Mike swiftly appears behind the second guy. He snatches the guy's head back by his hair. He firmly holds the gun above his victim's eyes.>

(MIKE)

Nah, fuck that! They got dope and if they don't run it they getting' smoked today!

Get the fuck up!

< He snatches the man's hair upwards. >

8. EXT. (Rooftop)

< Raindrops sprinkle on the closed metal door, and the rooftop. The closed door swings open and bangs against the wall. Mike shoves his two Spanish prisoners onto the roof. Bob is close behind. They gesture with their guns for the two men to walk near the air conditioner's generator. Their hands are still clenched on their heads. >

(MIKE)

[4

Now, who's gonna be the first to die muthafuckas?

[4

< Number two locks eyes as Mike waves the barrel at them. Number one tosses his arms in the air pleadingly. >

(#1 SPANISH MALE)

No, no, no, please! Mi amigo, please, we got no coke!
Papi, I swear it on my kids.

(MIKE)

So, that's how you want it?

< Mike fires two shots into the man's chest. He stumbles backwards before collapsing. His partner's jaw drops, and his eyes bulge as he stands frozen with fear. His comrade's body convulses down beside his leg. Mike glances over his shoulder to Bob. >

(MIKE)

Smash him!

< Bob steps up beside Mike, and takes aim. >

(BOB)

Bet.

< The prisoner begins to shuffle his feet, as if to tap dance. He holds his palms up. >

(#2 SPANISH MALE)

No, no, no, I give you pedico now! Just no shoot me!
Please, no shoot me!

< He drops his head and begins to whine.
The sound of running footsteps can be heard coming up the stairs. Bob dodges to the side as three Latino males emerge from the doorway. Mike grabs his prisoner around the neck, and spins around him. Mike and the newcomers immediately open fire. The new arrivals leap out of the doorway. >

< Mike's prisoner catches a bullet in the side. He tries to hold him erect as he slumps in his arms. Then, Mike's upper body jerks backwards as he catches

a slug beneath the heart. His grip tightens around his hostage's neck. He fires a shot. He hits his target in the center of the

chest. Another bullet hits the hostage in the chest. His eyes roll back and blood trails from the corner of his mouth. Mike releases the body. >

< The other men start shooting at Mike. He dives in the direction of his partner. Bob is lying on his side. He struggles to reload his gun. The pursuers spread out. They creep towards their prey. Mike begins to shoot at the men, in an effort to shield his friend. >

(MIKE)

Yo, son! I'm hit! Hurry up and reload that shit!
We got to break out!

< Bob continues to fumble with the last bullet. He finally pops it in the cylinder.

One of the attackers bear down on him. Mike and the pursuer, fire a shot at the same time. Mike's bullet lodges into the man's lower stomach. He grabs his abdomen, and drops to his knees before collapsing. >

< Mike locks eyes with Bob. He nods his head towards the exit. He then notices a small stream of blood coming from the hole in the center of his forehead. Now, he realizes that the eyes he is staring into are lifeless. >

(DOCTOR V.O.)

He's not going to make it.

< Mike scurries backwards. He grimaces as he pushes himself upwards. Shots are fired. His weak body thrusts forward as a bullet hits his buttock. He reaches for the railing on the roof, but tumbles over it. His body is falling through the air. He sees the canopy of the storefront before him.

9. INT. (Beauty salon)

< The salon owner is still stooped in front of the two toy pistol toting children.

(SALON OWNER)

Y'all ain't supposed to rob the people who changed your shitty diapers just a few years ago, ya hear? If you want a lot of money, go get yourselves some real pistols and go over to the
U.S. where all the money is

10.EXT. (Spanish drug dealers apartment building)

< Mike's body is still floating down from the rooftop. His eyes look below him in horror as his arms swing wildly. He crashes into the canopy, and the fruit stand beneath it.

He lies motionless, sprawled across the damaged stand, unconscious. Oranges and apples roll across the wet pavement. >

(DOCTOR V.O.)

There is nothing we can do for him. He's not going to make it. Just cut his clothes off of him and tag him for the morgue. Don't forget to check on Mrs. Collins with the severe burns

11. EXT. (Village in Jamaica)

< Three year old Mike stands with tears streaming down his cheeks, and a runny nose. A woman with caring eyes is stooped before him. She cradles one of his hands. Tears begin to swell in her eyes. >

(MOTHER)

You have the ability to live, kill, and survive. You are the keeper of your destiny.
Find courage and strength through the heart of the beast.

END OF FLASHBACKS

12. INT. (Presbyterian hospital)

< As Mike is being rushed through the hall on a stretcher, his eyes pop open. He grabs the doctor by the coat. >

(DOCTOR)

What the...

< The two doctors and the nurse stop the stretcher. Mike forces his body into an upright position. His shirt had been cut free. The front of his body is plastered with his blood. The bleeding bullet wound beneath his heart is visible. IV's are connected to his arms. >

< He pushes the doctor's arm away. He smothers his pain by biting down on his lower lip, as he stumbles off the stretcher. >

[_

(NURSE)

No sir, don't!

< She holds out her hand to stop him. He turns his sinister eyes upon her. He takes two steps in the opposite direction and faints. >

13. INT. (Hospital room – Late evening)

(SAMONE)

Mommy, please don't let them let him die.

< Mike's eyes slowly open. He sees Samone wrapped in her mother's embrace. Neither female is facing him. >

< He looks around the hospital room. He grimaces with pain as he tries to look down his body.>

(Ms. WILLIAMS)

They said, there is nothing they can do.
They also said, they didn't expect him to make it this far.
We just have to pray that he keeps fighting.

< He clears his throat. Samone spins her pregnant belly towards him. Both females approach him with tears pouring down their cheeks. Ms. Williams wraps her arms around her fifteen year old daughter. >

(SAMONE)

Hi, baby!

(MIKE)

How did you know I was here?

(SAMONE)

The hospital called us.
They found the piece of paper you wrote my new

number on. (MIKE)

[_

[. .

Did they find Bob?

(Ms. WILLAMS)

We don't know. They don't even know who you are.
I didn't know what to tell them. So, I didn't tell them
anything. The police are supposed to come back
and question you.

< Stacey the nurse smiled at him as she entered
the room. She comes over and checks his
temperature. >

(STACEY)

I'm glad to see you're awake. We were worried about you.

(SAMONE)

Nurse, is he going to be alright? Please, don't let him die!

(MIKE)

Stand me up!

< He startled them. They all stared at him in disbelief. >

(Samone)

Baby, you can't. You got shot twice and the bullet that went in your butt messed
up your legs. You won't be able to walk again. That's what the doctor said. Right,
nurse?

(MIKE)

Fuck them doctors! I've got things to do!
So, stand me the fuck up.
Now!!

< The nurse gently pressed her palm to his shoulder. >

[. .

[_

(STACEY)

Calm down,

sir. (MIKE)

Let me the fuck go! Get the fuck out! All of y'all!

< He winced with pain, as he gestured toward the exit. Tears began to fall from Samone's eyes. She lowers her head and slowly walks towards the door. The other two women follow her. She stops, walks back towards him, and places a small package containing five grams of coke into his hand. The nurse closes the door behind them. >

(STACEY)

You know, you're not supposed to have that. What are the chances of you giving it to me?

(MIKE)

If you help me get out of here, I'll give you some of it.

<He licks the top of his index finger, then stuffs it into the bag. He places his powder covered finger into his wounds. >

(STACEY)

What do you want me to do?

(MIKE)

Get me a wheelchair and a cab, and get me the fuck out of here.

(STACEY)

But, you're not well

(MIKE)

Yo, I just got to get out of here. Now, are you going to help me or not?
One way or another, I'm getting out of here.

(STACEY)

Okay, just stay put. I 'm going to do what I can.

< She strolls out of the room.>

14. EXT. (Presbyterian hospital)

< The automatic entrance doors open as Stacey uses it as an exit to push Mike's wheelchair out to the cab waiting at the curb. Mike has a baseball cap pulled down over his forehead, and dark sunglasses on.>

[_

< David, leaps out of the cab and goes to assist Stacey with her patient. She opens the cabs backdoor as David scoops an aching Mike into his arms.>

15. INT. (Mike's apartment in the Bronx)

< The iron metal door is closed. It has a cylinder in the keyhole. The cylinder is attached to a few heavy rubber bands and they are wrapped around a nail on the door.

< The door opens stubbornly. Mike is being led in by Stacey and David. He has one arm wrapped around each of their necks. The two strangers stop and stare in astonishment at the spacious apartment. The floor is covered from wall to wall with plush carpeting the color of red wine. The sitting chair, loveseat, and couch are made of expensive soft leather. There is a sixty inch wide screen projection television dominating one entire wall, and a state of the art entertainment center with audio equipment dominating another. Embedded into the wall behind the couch is a

huge two hundred and fifty gallon partitioned fish aquarium, occupied by exotic fish on one side, and healthy piranha on the other. A thick plexi-glass separates the amphibians. To the left of the aquarium is a gun rack, stocked with high powered assault rifles and handguns with silencers. It is within arm's reach from the couch.

(MIKE)

Take me over to the sofa.

< He winces as they gently set him down.

(MIKE)

Yo, nurse, reach behind this couch and grab that bag.

< She reaches behind the couch and hands him a black and red Adidas gym bag. David watches from his standing position by the sitting chair. Mike unzips the bag. >

(DAVID)

I have to get back to my cab.

(MIKE)

How much do you make in a day?

(DAVID)

About five hundred.

< Mike retrieves a stack of money from the bag. >

(MIKE)

I'll give you a thousand for twentyfour hours, plus a bonus if you take me downtown back to Harlem on Monday night.

(DAVID)

[14

Hell, yeah, that's what's up!

(STACEY)

What am I going to get?

[14

(MIKE)

I'll give you the same, as long as you help me the best you can.
Don't be up in here faking, hear what I'm saying?

(STACEY)

Yeah, I hear you. I'll do what I can. Whatever you need me to do.

16. INT. (Mike's apartment:Two hours later:Night)

< David is standing in front of the aquarium admiring the fish. Mike is lying on his right side, rubbing powder cocaine into his chest wounds. Stacey is redressing his other wound. There is an open plastic bag in front of him, with an ounce of powder cocaine in it.

Two hours later:

< David is standing beside Mike as he struggles to stand up. Stacey is standing in front of Mike cautiously cheering him to stand.

Three hours later:

< David is standing directly behind Mike. He holds the tips of his fingers gently under the teenager's arms. Stacey is standing two feet in front of him. She winces as he attempts to raise his foot. He collapses in David's arms.

Four hours later: Well after midnight

< David is asleep in a sitting position in the chair. Mike is laying on his right side asleep on the couch with pillows stacked behind him. Stacey has just completed redressing his wounds. She stares at him with a look of compassion and longing. She reaches out to caress the side of his face, but stops within inches of touching him.>

17. INT. (Mike's apartment:Sunday morning)

Stacey's eyes slowly open. She sees Mike trying to balance himself, so that he can stand upright. She glances over and sees David still asleep in the sitting chair. His shoes are off and his feet are propped up on the coffee table.

18. INT (Mike's apartment:Monday morning)

<There is a knock at the door. Mike paused. He is dressed in all black. There is another knock at the door. He eases his way back to the edge of the couch. He is slumped over. He takes short, painful steps towards the door. He has a harsh limp, but the thick carpet muffles his passage. He peers out through the peephole, then methodically opens the door. David walks in. he stops and stares curiously at Stacey, as she enters the room wearing a large tshirt. He could tell she wasn't wearing a bra. He follows Mike into the living room. He stops and leans against the projector. He starts tossing his keys in the air. Stacey disappears into the bedroom.>

(Mike)

You ready for your bonus?

< Mike pulls out a wad of cash from the pockets of his sweatpants.>

[16

(DAVID)

[16

Fosheezy!

(Mike)

Cool. Now, all I need you to do is drive us down to these muthafuckas coke spot. If po-po stops us, just tell them I held you at gunpoint.

< Stacey returns fully dressed. She sees Mike hand David a stack of money. He then does the same for her.

(Stacey)

Thank
you.

(David)

Good looking out man.

(Mike)

You got that. I thank y'all for looking out for me like you did.

< He drops his gaze and goes over to the gun rack. He grabs a chrome nine millimeter pistol, and five clips. He stuffs them in his waistline. He then grabs an AK-47 assault rifle. He turns and looks seriously at David.>

(Mike)

Time to
roll!

19. INT. (David's cab)

< Mike is staring at a dingy two story row house on a residential street. There is a light rain falling. The light rumble of the car's engine is the only sound.

(Mike)

Wait
here.

< David glances over his shoulder and nods to his passenger. Mike exits the car.

20. EXT. (Residential street)

< The street is empty of people as Mike exits from the backseat of the car. He holds the AK-47 against his leg, as he limps up to a dirty pink brick house. Perhaps by adrenaline, his walk is a little stronger than before. Yet, still the pain caused him to walk hunched over a bit.

< He knocks on the door. He holds the assault rifle hidden behind his leg. He looks mournfully up to the sky.>

(Mike)

<Mumbling>

Watch me get down, Homey. This one's for you

(Spanish

[18

girl) Just a
minute!

[18

< He focuses on the door. He hears the door unlock. It opens partially and a woman in her late teens peers out from behind the chain on the door.>

(Spanish girl)

If you looking for Poppi, don't come here! You should know he don't serve here

< He fought back a grin.

(Mike)

N-n-no. I jjust ttalked to PPoppi at the ppay phphone.

He told me to ccome h-here and get something straight from here.

< She stares scornfully at him. He brings the assault rifle from behind his leg. He sticks it under her chin as her eyes bulge. >

(Mike)

Bitch, just open the door, don't say nothing! Just open the door. Don't make me kill you!

(Spanish girl)

No, please. I open door, I open door. Just don't hurt Poppi, please.

< She closes the door a little to remove the chain.

(Poppi V.O.)

What the fuck's going on Valerie?

< Poppi's large frame stood towering behind Valerie, as she holds the front door partially open. Mike bursts into the house and aims the assault rifle at Poppi. He back kicks the door closed. Poppi is stunned. He regains his composure and points at Mike.

(Poppi)

I know you muthafucka!

You're one of the maricons who robbed my fucking spot three days ago!

(Mike)

Yeah! You should've killed me too.

Now, I'm gonna make you wish you did!

(Poppi)

Fuck
you!

(Spanish girl)

No! Please, Poppi. Just give him some shit, so he can leave.

(Poppi)

Alright, alright! Valerie, go get those last twenty kilos and the money.
Bring it out here.

[20

(Mike)

Put a, don't try nothing slick, and bring me a bag.

[20

< She repeatedly brings out kilos of cocaine and money, wrapped separately in clear plastic, and stacks it on the table between the two men.>

< She then brings out two duffle bags, and drops them beside the other stuff. She then throws herself into Poppi's arms.

(Spanish girl)

That's all we got. Now, would you please leave us alone?

We don't want no trouble.

(Mike)

Oh, one thing you got is trouble. You see, Poppi killed my homeboy, and owes him an apology.

Understand what I'm saying? So, I think it's best that he apologize to him personally.

(Spanish
girl) You
bastard!

21. INT (David's car)

< David is parked outside of Poppi's house. He is looking through his side mirror. The street is empty of both people and vehicles. Six gunshots ring out. David's head jerks towards Poppi's closed front door. Suddenly, the door opens, and Mike steps out the door, struggling to drag a duffle bag. >

< David leaps out of the car and swiftly walks towards Mike. David takes the bag from Mike and carries it towards the car. Mike limps back into the house. >

22. INT. (Mike's apartment)

< Mike is laying on his side. Stacey is redressing his wounds. The two duffle bags that he took from Poppi's house are on the floor near him. David is seated on the chair. He is exhausted. He has his fingers clasped on top of his head. He is staring curiously at the bags. Mike stares suspiciously at him.

(Mike)

Look, I really don't know how to say this, so I'm just going to say it. I really want y'all to stay a little longer. I mean, I ain't all that well yet. So, I could use y'all's help still. What cha think? I mean, I will pay y'all for it.

(David)

Alright, I already lost my job two days ago anyway. I could use the money since I'm renting the cab now.

(Stacey)

I'll stay as long as you need me.

< David looks over into her eyes. She drops her eyes and finishes dressing
Mike's wounds. >

23. INT. (Mike's apartmentNight)

< Stacey is asleep, curled up on the couch. David is not in his room. Mike is seated with most of his buttocks off the edge of the couch. He is seated near her feet. He is looking down the inside of his shirt, while his other hand is underneath it at the bottom. He removes his hand from under his shirt and dips his index finger into an open zip lock bag beside him. The bag is third of the way filled with powder cocaine. His powder covered fingers disappear back under his shirt to the wound. >

(Stacey)

It's not going to heal if you keep playing with it.

(Mike)

Playing with it? I ain't playing with that shit! It's starting to hurt again.

< The doorbell rings.

(Stacey)

What was
that?

(Mike)

My
doorbell.

< He limps over to the door. He removes the top of the cylinder, and peers through it.

(Mike)

What you
want?

(Woman V.O.)

Three nickel bags and a trey bag.

(Mike)

Alright, send it through

< He removes a roll of money that is pushed through the cylinder. He counts it and then stuffs it in his pocket. He then retrieves several small zip-lock bags from his hoodie pocket. The bags are stuffed with marijuana. He selects three and pushes them through the cylinder.>

(Woman)

I came here over the weekend, but you were closed.
Is everything alright? I thought maybe five-o shut you down.

(Mike)

Nah, we cool. Thanks for your concern, and have a nice day.

< He moves back towards the couch.>

(Stacey)

[24

Well, I'll be damned! This is a weed spot, ain't it?

(Mike)

[24

Hell no! This ain't no weed spot! A weed spot is known for pushing cheap home grown bush. I don't deal with nothing but the best shit. "Thai stick, Hawaiian bud, red head sensi," nothing but the chronic.

24. EXT. (Bronx zoo Day)

< David stops his cab in front of the zoo. The sun is shining and small crowds of people are entering and leaving the park.>

25. INT. (David's cab)

< The cab is still parked in front of the zoo. David is seated behind the wheel. Mike is seated in the back. He has on an Adidas sweat suit. He also has on a thick, flat, platinum necklace called a "Cuban link." It bears a lion's head medallion that is embedded with diamonds.>

(Mike)

I'll be back in five minutes.

< He exits the car.>

26. EXT. (Bronx zoo)

< Mike is standing in front of the lion's cage. He takes a deep breath and looks around to see if he is being watched. He turns back towards the cage. The huge lion paces from side to side, staring at him. Mike lowers himself to his knees, and the lion stops in front of him. His huge face is inches from Mike's. He can feel the low vibrating sound coming from its throat. The animal lies down on his stomach and bobs its head, acknowledging Mike.

< Mike stares into the creature's eyes.>

(Mike)

Oh, mighty "King of the jungle." Please forgive me for my sins. I know man is not supposed to kill as you do, oh mighty one. But, getting by in my own jungle is a bitch and survival is only gained by the strong. I am alone, oh mighty one. I ask of you to continue to give me strength. I have killed before, and I know I will again. I ask your forgiveness now.

< Mike stands. His eyes remained locked with those of the lion.>

<The beast lets out a ferocious roar.>

27. INT. (Kim's apartment building Hallway)

< Mike and David are standing in the dingy hallway in front of Kim's door. Mike knocks on the door. They can hear the squeak of the apartment's floor as someone approaches the door.>

(Kim V.O.)

Yo, who's there?

(Mike)

[26

It's me baby. Open up.

28. INT. (Kim's living room)

[26

< Pregnant fifteen year old Kim, leads Mike and David into the pleasantly furnished room. Her wild-eyed mother rushes into the room and confronts Mike.

(Ms. Johnson)
Where the fuck is my
son?

< Mike looks confused.

(Ms. Johnson)
I said, where the fuck is my son? He don't do shit but run around with fools like you! Now, where the hell is he? I ain't seen his black ass since Friday, and he knows I need money for the rent this week!

<Mike looks to the floor, and exhales deeply before looking at her directly.>

(Mike)
He's dead, Ms. Johnson.

(Ms. Johnson)
Nono, no, no! God
almighty! No!

< She begins pounding Mike all over his face and wounded body. He reaches for his pistol, but draws back, covering his face as she continues to vent her frustration physically.>

(Ms. Johnson)
He was all I had you bastard! I know he was with you! I know he was with you!

< Kim stands there trembling and crying. David is standing behind them, looking perplexed. Kim goes and grabs her mother. She is trying to pull her off him, but they all fall to the floor crying.

<Mike staggers to his feet. He wipes his eyes, then he helps David pull Ms. Johnson to her feet. She goes and sits down on the couch. Kim disappears in the back of the apartment. Mike goes and sits down beside her. Kim returns and hands them both a wet towel. She goes and sits down on the opposite side of her mother.

(Ms. Johnson)
Where's his
body?

(Mike)
It's at the Presbyterian hospital on 168th and Broadway in Manhattan.
Some dudes tried to kill us both.

(Ms.
Johnson)
But, you
[27

lived.

< Mike looks at the floor. Then he looks back at Ms. Johnson.

(Mike)

I got something else to tell you.

(Ms. Johnson)

What can be worse than what you already told me?

(Mike)

I don't think this is a bad thing.
Kim and I think it's pretty good news.

< Kim's eyes widen.>

(Ms. Johnson)

And what in the hell does Kim have to do with it?

(Mike)

Ms. Johnson, I know you don't like me, but the baby Kim is carrying is mine. I wanted to tell you sooner, but Kim thought it was best we wait until after the baby was born. And I, as a man, had to respect my woman's wishes.

(Ms. Johnson)

As a man? Little boy, who the fuck do you think you're fooling? You just started getting a few hairs on your damn little dick, and you come into my house after you done got my son killed, and tell me my daughter is having your child! You ain't shit, but a thirteen year old little evil ass, Jamaican punk muthafucka. I hate your guts! Get the fuck out of my house. Now!! And take your muthafucking friend with you!!

29. INT. (David's cab -Evening)

< He is driving through light traffic. Stacey is seated in the passenger seat. She looks preoccupied as she stares through the window with her arms folded across her chest.>
< She exhales a deep breath and looks over at David.>

(Stacey)

What happened when you and Mike left this morning?

(David)

What makes you ask that? Is something wrong?

(Stacey)

No, nothing's wrong. It's just that when y'all came back, he seems really upset and out of it.
I just figured something happened.

(David)

Let's just say that he had another bad day.
Can you believe he's only thirteen fucking years old?

(Stacey)

[30

Who?

(David)
Mike.

(Stacey)
Get the fuck outta here! I knew he looked young, but I figured that he was at least nineteen. Damn! He's so mature to be only thirteen. What the hell made him so hard? That shit is wild.

(David)
Nah, he's wild.

30. INT (Mike's apartment Night)
< He lets David and Stacey into the apartment. After he secures the door, Stacey hugs him and kisses him on the left side of his face.>

(Stacey)
Don't feel bad baby, I'll never leave. I got your back.

<He lays his head against her chest and closes his eyes, lost in the comfort.>
< Then his eyes pop open as he steps back.>

(Mike)
Bitch, are you crazy? Get the fuck off me!

< He shoves her back, but she continues to reach out for him>.

(Stacey)
Baby, don't be like that. I'm just trying to help and protect you.
What's so wrong with that?

< He snatches his gun from his waistline and aims it at her face.>

(Mike)
Bitch, this right here is the only fucking protection I need, and if you don't stop whatever you're up to, I will put some of these shells in you. You understand? Huh?

< She runs over to the couch and buries her face in the cushion, sobbing loudly.>
< Mike looks at David. David returns his gaze with a tinge of reproach.>

(Mike)
Fucking women been giving me problems all my damn life.
Now, this bitch comes trying to use me. If she makes me fuck her up, I will.

(David)
Look man, we went out of our way to help you out. I lost my job and she probably

[30

has too. If this is the way you're going to treat us, we can bounce up outta here if that's what you want.

She cares about you for real, man. She ain't got nothin' as it is, and you wanna treat her like some shit.

That ain't right, man. It ain't right, and I don't appreciate that shit.

< Mike looks stunned.>

(Mike)

Ahight man, you got that. Shit is just hard for me right now.

(David)

Yeah, it's cool. But, it's not really me you should be saying all that to.
Give her a break.

< Mike puts the gun in his waistline, as he goes over and sits on the edge of the couch.>
< Her face is still buried in the cushion. He caresses her head. She turns over and sits up, and he hugs her. < She holds his hands as he struggles to look into her eyes.>

(Mike)

I didn't mean none of that. I'm just going through some
shit right now I didn't mean to take it out
on you.

(Stacey)

I understand. I'm sorry for being so weak and all.

<He held her hands against his lips and kissed them.>

(Mike)

Don't apologize for that.

31. INT. (Ms. Williams house – Living room – Early morning)

< Sunshine was streaming through the thin flowered curtains and brightening the living room.>

< Mike and Samone are seated on the couch in front of the window.>

< Ms. Williams walks into the house through the front door. Seven year old Renee is trailing behind her. She is carrying a plastic shopping bag. Ms. Williams goes over and kisses Mike on the cheek. Renee flops down on the couch beside him.>

(Ms. Williams)

How are you feeling? Are you okay?

(Mike)

I'm okay, Ms. Williams. How are you?

(Ms. Williams)

Hell, I'm okay now. I've been worried
about you. I'm glad to see you up and
about. You look good too.

< Renee leans over and grabs his head. She kisses him on the cheek.>

(Renee)

Thank you! Thank you! I like my name plate! I can't wait to wear it to school. You know, old Shirley Dukes thinks she's got everything. When she sees what you got me, she's going to throw up! I can't wait!

(Mike)

Anything for you, Renee. You know you're my favorite sister.

< She kisses him on the cheek again. She grabs her bag and dashes up the stairs singing a school song.>

< Ms. Williams strolls over to the living room closet. She grunts as she retrieves a Safeway shopping bag. She sits the bag on the coffee table in front of Mike.>

(Ms. Williams)

All of your things are in there. I got them when you put us out the hospital. They gave me hell to get that stuff. They kept asking "What's your name?" I told the woman I'm stressed out, I ain't trying to hear it, and that I would give her everything as soon as I get out to the car. You know me!

< The teenagers laugh. Then Mike pulls out his torn bloody shirt. He inspects it, then lies it across his lap.

< Next he pulls out his bloody coat, and smiles.>

(Mike)

Oh
shit!

(Samone)

What?

< He unzips the lining of the coat and begins pulling out all the stacks of money. He places it all on the table. The women look as if they are seeing a ghost.>

(Ms. Williams)

How much money is that?

(Mike) Eighty
thousand.

(Samone)

Damn! What are you going to do with all that money?

(Mike)

I'm going to give my homeboy's mom half of it. I'll leave twenty here for y'all and keep the other twenty. Samone, go get me a bag to put this into.

32. INT (Greg and Keenya's house -Basement)

< Mike follows a visibly high Greg into the room. Parliament's song "Flashlight," is blaring throughout the basement.>

< Thick Keenya and seven other strangers are gathered around and near a coffee table, smoking and snorting lines of cocaine. Mike smiles as Keenya looks up from snorting a line of cocaine.>

(Keenya)
Hey Mike! What's happening?

< Mike glanced at one of the people smoking freebase. Greg walks over and sits beside him.

(Mike)
What's up
Keenya?

< She holds up a dollar bill filled with powder cocaine.>

(Keenya)
You want some of this?

< He limps over and sits on the arm of the couch. He takes the dollar bill. He scoops up some of the cocaine and snorts it.>

33. INT. (Mike's grandmother's house)
< The chubby woman opens the door. Mike smiles. He is stoned. She sees David's cab parked at the curb. He steps inside the house and closes the door. She is standing directly in front of him with her hand on her hips, frowning.>

(Grandmother –Jamaican
accent) Where you been
boy?

< Mike tries to walk past her, but she blocks his path.>

(Grandmother)
You know, you go to court tomorrow for breaking into them white people's houses. I don't know why you do things like that. Just look at you! All dressed up in them hip-hop clothes. Why can't you be more like Kenny?
He goes to school, helps out around here, and works at your daddy's carpentry company out west.

(Mike)
Grandma, come
now.

(Grandmother)

You make me sick! You keep causing trouble and then try and hide out in my damn house. If it wasn't for your daddy coming, I'd toss you out of here. But, I'm glad you're here, because I told him how you locked me out of my own damn basement, and he wants to see you about it.

< She frowns and shakes her head at him. Then she steps out of his path. He limps over to the basement door, and opens it. He steps through the door and slams it shut. He locks it.>

34. INT. (Mike's grandmother's house – Basement)

< Mike struggles as he makes his way down the flight of stairs.>

(Grandmother V.O.)

Somebody in these streets been whipping on your ass I see! That's exactly what you need. If your daddy would've given you to me when you was a baby like Kenny, I would have been putting that strap to your hide, and made sure you wouldn't have turned out evil and crazy.

< Mike goes and lies across his bed. He closes his

eyes.> FLASHBACK: INT. (Tommy's house –

Living room)

< Mike is eleven years old. He is seated on a soft cream colored leather couch. Tommy is seated in an expensive matching chair across from him. The sunrays beaming through the window behind Tommy, engulfs his dreadlocks.>

(Mike)

When you turn Rasta, yo?

(Tommy – Jamaican accent)

When I let Jah Rastafari into I and I heart. Don't you know, Ron is a Rasta?

(Mike)

Nah, I didn't know. But that explains why he's been acting so funny.

(Tommy)

What do you mean, funny, Mon?

(Mike)

He be tripping out sometimes. He won't let me eat meat up in his spot, because he don't eat it no more. Like when my girl brings some friend chicken and rice to the spot, we got to eat it up before he gets home.

(Tommy)

That's not a bad thing, Mon.

(Mike)

Yo, bust this shit out, son. We be there smashing all types of meat, and five minutes before he comes home. I be at the back window throwing a fucking ton of bones out there.

(Tommy)
What's so funny about that?

(Mike)
It's funny because of the rats! These huge fat ass rats be out there every fucking day at the same time, waiting for me to toss that shit out there. I mean, you got to see these fucking things kid! They be out there standing on their hind legs, looking up at the window like, "Feed us homie! Feed us! We hungry as shit out here!"

< Tommy shakes his head, as he looks at Mike with a smirk on his face.>

(Tommy)
Yo, don't you ever get scared or lonely up there in the Bronx, living in that old ass abandoned building by yourself?

(Mike)
What? Shit, son, I love it! I love being alone. Especially helping my big brother get paid. Hell, I'm going to inherit that shit one day. I got to put my work in. No doubt, son. No doubt.

(Tommy)
Baby cousin, you need to do something better for yourself. You need to get down with this Rasta thing Mon, for real. See, you been brainwashed in New York. But, Jah will guide and protect you from all that. You just need Jah in your heart.

(Mike)
I don't walk the streets without my pistol, son. That's all the protection I need. My gun hasn't failed me yet. Speaking of guns, let me get the one you were supposed to give me while I'm in Miami.

< Tommy reaches inside his jacket and pulls out a revolver. He hands it to Mike.>

(Tommy)
You're crazy,
Mon!

(Mike)
What the fuck am I supposed to do with this?
You ain't got no automatics?

(Tommy)
Yeah, but I ain't giving you one to throw away. You can use that. You shouldn't have no drama down here. Hell, you'll be back on the plane right after you get the shit to take to your brother.

< Tommy's wife walks into the room. She stares angrily at Mike, as her mouth opens.> FLASHBACKS END AT THE SOUND OF HIS FATHERS

VOICE

(Chauncey V.O.)

Open up this door before I kick the muthafucka down!

< He gets up and as fast as he can, opens the door.>

(Chauncey V.O.)
Where the hell you
been?

The police been by here since last Friday looking for you!
< Mike waves him off, and makes his way back down the staircase. He follows him.>

(Chauncey)
You don't believe shit stink, do you?

< Mike goes and sits with his buttocks on the edge of the bed. Chauncey stands beside him.>

(Mike)
Man, I ain't trying to hear none of that. I'm tired.

(Chauncey)
Tired? Well, you fucking base head thief, we'll see how tired your little ass is come tomorrow when I tell the judge to get you off my hands. Me and momma tried hard to raise you and Kenny. He's doing what he should, but you still fucking up.

(Mike)
You
finished?

(Chauncey)
Damn right, I'm finished. In more ways than one.
I want you to get the fuck out of my mother's house!

(Mike)
Where the hell is my mother?
Why won't you give me the information I need to find her?

(Chauncey)
What? Your fucking mother don't want you!
Her hoe ass is down in Miami living good, minding her business, and not giving
a fuck about you!
Now, get the fuck out of this house!

< Mike does not move. His father cocks his hand back as if to slap him.>
< Mike whips his gun out as he springs to his feet, and aims it between the man's eyes.

(Mike)
Nigga, I will kill your muthafucking ass
right here! I didn't ask to be bought into
this fucked up world.
Your black ass brought me here.

< His father is consumed with fear. The gun quivers in Mike's hand as he stares insanely into the man's glazed eyes.

< Footsteps can be heard coming casually down the steps. Mike's brother, Kenny, pauses at the end of the steps when he sees them. He is the brother that tried to rob the beauty salon with Mike using a toy pistol.

(Kenny)

< Kenny speaks
calmly>

Mike, come on man, don't do it. Please, don't

do it. (Mike)

You heard what this piece of shit just said about mommy?

< He walks over and stands beside Mike.>

(Kenny)

Remember our promise that we would always be there for each other? Well, you're about to do something stupid and I'm here for you now. No matter what you think of pops, I love you and he's still our father. If that promise we made back in Jamaica meant anything to you, spare our father's life man.

< Mike looks into his father's frightened eyes, He tilts the gun slightly as if preparing to pull the trigger.>

< He looks to Kenny, and they share a gaze. He looks back to his father.>

< He drapes his free hand around his brother's neck, hugging him, but never lowering the gun.>

(Mike)

This one here is for you Kenny.

Because of our promise, I won't kill him. I'll keep my word.

<He lowers the gun.>

(Kenny)

Thank you, man. Everything is going to be cool.

(Mike)

Kenny just saved your life, you worthless piece of shit.

I hate you, you fake ass nigga.

< Mike stuffs the gun back into his waistline, and makes his way up the steps.>

< Tears begin to roll from his father's eyes. He lowers his head.>

(Chauncey)

Where did I go
wrong?

What kind of monster have I brought into this world?

Oh, my God, please forgive me.

35. INT. (Mike's apartment – Living room Night)

<Curtis Mayfield's song, "Freddie's dead," is playing at a semi-loud volume. >
< With a look of worry, Stacey paces back and forth across the carpet.>
< There's a knock at the door. She pauses and goes over to the door, and peers through the peephole.>
< She sees Mike and David.>

(Stacey)
Is everything okay out there?

< Mike smiles.>

(Mike)
Every thing's cool baby, it's just us. Let us in.

< She opens the door. They stroll into the apartment, and she fastens the door behind them.

(Stacey)
I cooked baby. We can all eat now if you want.
I don't know about y'all, but I'm hungry.

(Mike)
Hell yeah, we can eat now.
I'm starving like a runaway slave.

< David rubs his stomach before sitting down.

(David
) Me
too.

(Stacey)
Okay, I'll be right
back. You two just
have a seat.

< Mike sits. She cheerfully strolls into the kitchen, and returns with two plates. She hands one to each of them.
< She repeats her actions and returns with two sodas. The third time she returns with her own food.>
< She sits next to Mike, stealing glances at him as they eat.>
< He signals her with a wink and a smile, that the food is good.>

36. INT. (Mike's bedroom – Night)

< Mike is pulling a pair of shorts up over his boxers. There are drops of water on his back.>
< He has a bath towel over his shoulder. There is a knock on the closed bedroom

[46

door. He looks at the door.>

(Mike)
What's
up?

[46

(Stacey
V.O.) Are you
dressed?

(Mike)
Yeah, come on
in.

< She slowly opens the door and enters the room. He looks curiously at her.

(Stacey)
I was wondering if you wanted to put the bandages back on now.

< He looks down at the healing wound. He touches the chest wound with his fingertips.
He smiles.>

(Mike)
It's healing pretty damn fast. Look, there's a scab growing.
She walks up and scans it.

(Stacey)
Yeah, it is, but it's not that healed on the inside.
So, let me go ahead and rebandage them. Oh, you're still wet.
Let me dry you off before you catch a cold.

< Before he can say a word, she grabs the towel, and starts drying off his chest.
< She glances up into his eyes, then she stares into them with a look of desire.
< Her hands stop moving. He looks down at the wound, then he looks into her eyes.

(Mike)
You
alright?
< She drops her gaze and moves around to his back, and proceeds to dry him off.>

(Stacey)
Yeah, why you ask that?
< She grabs the bandages off of the dresser, and begins to dress up his wounds.>
< He peers over his shoulder as she worked on the lower wound.>

(Mike)
Because you were just looking like something was on your mind.

(Stacey)
Oh, I was just thinking about my mother.

(Mike)
She
[47

[48

alright?

(Stacey)

[48

Yeah, I think so. I'm just a little worried. She has sickle cell. I haven't talked to her since the day I met you. I tried to call today, but she didn't answer the phone. She probably went out for a walk.

< She moves around him and starts working on the chest wound.>

(Mike)

You want me to tell David to take you over there?

(Stacey)

No, I'll just try to contact her in the morning.

< David knocks on the door as he sticks his head into the room.>

< He looks quizzically at them.>

(Mike)

What's
up?

< He steps into the room and lies a small stack of money on the dresser.

(David)

I just made you two hundred and fifty dollars.
My first dishonest day of good work.

(Mike)

You like that? See? Chronic sells itself.

< David turns and walks out. He closes the door behind him.>

< She stands up straight and smiles at him.>

(Stacey)

All
finished.

< He scans her handy work. She goes over and opens the window.>

< He puts on a shirt. He goes and lies across the bed on his good side.>

(Mike)

Don't forget to close that window tonight.

< She steps over the bed.>

(Stacey)

Okay, can I lie down with you for a while?
Then I'll go clean up the kitchen.

(Mike)

Alrigh
t.

< He takes her by the hand, and pulls her over to him.>
< She lies beside him and begins to caress his chest.>

< He closes his eyes.>

37. EXT. (Mike's building – Back area – Later)

< Derrick and three other unkempt teenagers are seated and standing around the makeshift playground of old tires, smoking freebase.>

< Derrick's attention is on Mike's second floor window. The building has been nearly demolished.>

< It looks as if it will collapse any minute. Most of the remaining windows are either shattered or boarded up.>

(Derrick)

Ay, yo.

< His crew looks at him. He points to Mike's open window.>

(Derrick)

That's the window to Mike's "Herb gates"

I saw some bitch open it about an hour ago. Somebody cut the light off twenty minutes ago.

Y'all trying to get up in there?

(Taz)

Yea

h.

(Derrick)

Yo, "Rock, me, Flip, and Taz," are going up there.

I want you to keep a lookout down here.

(Rock)

Bet. We finally caught this little muthafucka slipping.

< Derrick heads towards the building with two of the others in tow.>

< They jog across the street and begin to climb the fire escape.>

< They stop beside Mike's window. Derrick peeps in.>

(Derrick)

Yo, these muthafuckas in there asleep.

<He signals Taz to climb in the window first. Taz sticks one of his legs inside the window as he places one hand on the windowpane to hold himself up.>

< The window bangs into the outside wall, from the pressure of his hand.>

38. INT. (Mike's bedroom)

< Mike and Stacey are still lying across the bed. She is asleep.>

< He looks across her body to see Taz's leg hanging over the window sill.>

(Derrick V.O.)

You damn fool! What the fuck you trying to do, wake him up?
Nigga, be quiet.

< Mike eases his hand under his pillow and pulls the handle of the gun in view.>

(Taz V.O.)
I'm straight.

< Taz's whole side is now in the room.>

< Mike starts easing out of the bed.

(Taz)
Yo, I'm almost
in. We got
'em. (Derrick
V.O) Hurry
up.

< As soon as Taz's body is all the way in the room, three flames begin to jump in the darkness as Mike pulls the trigger three times.

< Taz's body slumps to the floor.

(Derrick V. O.)
Move! Move!
Move!

< The squeaking of the fire escape can be heard under frantic footsteps.>

< Mike sprints over to the window. He fires three more shots at the three men fleeing up the alleyway.>

< Derrick glances back, and locks eyes with Mike for a hot second.>

< Mike spins around as the room door slams into the back wall.>

< He aims the gun at David as he clicks on the light. He glances from a hysterical Stacey, to Mike, then down to Taz's bloody, lifeless body.>

< Mike has one foot on top of the dead man's chest.>

(David)
What the fuck happened in here?

< Mike shakes his weapon at the corpse, as he thrusts his foot off of him.

(Mike)
These mutha's tried to rob me!

< David points to the corpse.

(David)
What are we supposed to do now?
You know the cops will be here any minute.

[54

(Mike)

We're going to throw this bastard over the fire escape, and chill.

[54

Help me toss him.

39. INT. (Mike's living room – Early morning)

< Mike is fully dressed. He is seated on the edge of the couch with his head pressed against the back of it.>

< He's smoking herb, as Stacey is balled up beside him asleep. David is asleep in the sitting chair.>

< On the coffee table is a flat dollar bill with powder cocaine smeared over it. Beside it is a halffilled glass of water.>

< Mike limps over to the stereo system, He grabs Anita Baker's "Rapture" album, and places it on the turntable. He turns it on with the volume on low. Anita's voice creeps around the room.>

< He puffs his joint, and nods his head to the music.>

< Stacey sits up. His eyes were bloodshot red. She scoops up some of the cocaine into her nail and sniffs it.>

< Mike turns towards her. She takes a drink of the water.>

(Mike)

Did I wake you?

(Stacey)

No, I can't sleep. Can I ask you something?

Do you ever think about getting out of this line of work?

(Mike)

No, I can't say that I have. All I know is the streets. I didn't mention it before because I forgot myself.

I have to go to court in Jersey this morning for some bullshit.

< David stretches and yawns.>

(Stacey)

Is it serious? Whatever it is, I'll be there for you.

Can I help?

(Mike)

No, I really don't know how serious it is, but this is my problem.

I can handle it.

(Stacey)

Well, can I come with you baby?

(Mike)

No, I told you I handle my own business.

As a matter of fact, I won't be needing y'all's help any longer. So, I'll be looking out for y'all before you leave this morning.

[56

(Stacey)
I don't want your damn money!

[56

< She folds her arms across her chest, as tears fall from her eyes.>
< Mike disappears into his bedroom. He returns carrying a gym bag. He sits it on the coffee table.>
< He pulls out two stacks of money. He hands one to David.>
< Stacey will not accept the other, so he sits it on the table in front of her.>
< She leaps up and hugs him, crying.>

(Stacey)

No, baby. I don't want you to leave
I love you. Don't you know I love you?

< He pry's her off of him, and holds her at arm's length.>

(Mike)

You can't love a nigga like me. Now, get your shit and step.
Take the money and go. I got your bags by the door.
I hope everything works out with your mother.

< She opens her mouth to speak.>

(Mike V.O.)

Don't speak. Just do what I say, alright?

< He looks to David.>

(Mike)

As far as that old dude at the liquor store who killed your father, whenever you get it in your heart to avenge him, come and see me. I'll be your driver.

< David shook his hand.

(David)

You take care of yourself kid. You hear me?

< Mike nods his head.>
< Stacey picks up the money still crying, and storms over to the door.>
< David reaches out his hand, and brushes his palm over Mike's shoulder.>

40. INT. (Mike's living room – Thirty minutes later)

< Mike pulls the front door open.>
< His older brother, Ron, walks into the apartment.>
< He has a head full of dreadlocks. He looks around astonished.>

(Ron)

Goddamn! Nigga, you got this spot flyer than my own fucking crib!
Yo, how you get all this fly shit?

(Mik

I did it just like you told me when you was running the spot the first year. I just kept re-upping and flipping my shit. I made sure the connect had his money, and stacked mine in the floor of the bedroom closet. The same spot you kept your dough, son.

(Ron)

Fuck how you hustled. Just tell me how in hell you furnished this spot. That's the biggest T.V. out, and I know I just saw that stereo system in the latest "High fidelity" magazine.

< Mike glances at the floor, and looks sadly into his brother's eyes.>

(Mike)

I got something to tell you that I'm not proud of.

(Ron)

What the hell you talking
about, son? (Mike)
Don't trip, but I been freebasing.

< Ron frowns, then opens his mouth to speak.

(Mike)

I got all my homies in Jersey robbing and stealing to support our habits. We hit houses, stores, and we got females charging credit cards. At first, I was taking it to the Dominicans. Then I said, fuck that, and filled up this spot with the shit you see now. The rest I sold, bought more chronic, and coke, and started selling the shit. I blew up and became a man. "The" man.

(Ron)

So, how in the fuck you start smoking?

(Mike)

Remember when you sent me to Miami to pick up some ganja for you?

(Ron)

Yeah, that was a while ago.

(Mike)

When Tommy dropped me off at "Columbian Juaney's," he showed me how to use that shit, and I've been on it pretty hard ever since. But, as you can see for yourself, I still hold it down and take care of my business.

(Ron)

The last time the cops raided this place, we moved out. You telling me you stayed here and continued to run the "Gates" on your own?

(Mik

Word. You taught me well, my nigga.
But, this getting high shit won't make it. You know what I mean?

(Ron)
You been running this spot for two years now. I'm somewhat proud of you.
But, we got to get you off of that bullshit. I can't have my little brother being no
base head.

(Mike)
That's part of the reason I called you over here.
I got to show you some shit.

< Mike motioned Ron to follow.>

41. INT. (Mike's bedroom)

< Mike pulls back a wall panel in his closet. Ron stares over his brother's
shoulder, and smiles when he sees the large cast iron safe behind the
panel.>

< Mike uses the proper combination on the safe's lock and swings the door
open. He steps aside and gestures towards the safe.>

(Mike)
Come check this out.

< Ron stares in amazement. Half of the safe is packed tight with stacks of
money. The other half is packed tight with thick packages.>

(Ron)
Where did you get all that
money? And what the fuck is in
those packages?

(Mike)
Never mind where, but that's two hundred thousand dollars.
Twenty kilos of coke, and twelve pounds of chronic.

(Ron)
Get the fuck out of here!

(Mike)
No bullshit. Look, I got to go to court in jersey at ten:thirty this morning, and I don't
think they will be letting me out. So, I'm leaving all this shit to you to keep rolling
until I get out. All I ask of you is to look out for Samone and Kim. They're having my
babies. Plus, I want you to find mommy and give her some money. Do you know

[60

where she is?

(Ron)

[60

Nah, nobody knows exactly where she is. All we know is that she is in Miami
with our sister.

I heard they're with some nigga down there.

42. EXT. (Pay phone)

< Ron places the phone receiver to his ear, drops some change in the slot,
and dials.>

< Mike is seated on the passenger seat of Ron's 530 I BMW.>

(Ron)

Hey baby, I see you're up early. What's wrong? Well, when is your period due? You
don't think so? It'll be alright. Sweetheart, if we are having a child, there won't be
nothing to worry about. I promise you that. Look, I'll see you shortly. I'm okay. Bye.

< He hangs up the phone and jogs around to the driver side of his car.>

43. INT. (Ron's BMW)

< Ron stops the car in front of Mike's grandmother's house. He looks over at Mike.>

(Mike)

Yo, you coming in?

(Ron)

Nah, man. You know I ain't trying to see Chauncey's punk ass. That nigga always
hated me because I ain't his. And I don't feel like hearing how much better Kenny is
than us. I'm going home to my wife.

(Mike)

Alright
homie.

< Mike pulls a key ring from his pocket with four keys on it. He hands it to Ron.>

(Mike)

The smallest key is for the door at the "Herb gates." The rest
are just on there I don't know how long I'll be gone, but I'll
see you when I get out.

< They give each other a brotherly fist bump.>

(Ron)

I got you little bro.

< Mike exits the car.>

44. INT (Courtroom)

< Mike and his attorney are standing behind the defendants table. The prosecutor is

behind her table. The Judge is looking over the top of his half-glasses.>

< Kenny and Chauncey are seated on the pew directly behind Mike. There are other juveniles and their

parents seated around the courtroom.>

< The bailiff is standing by the door that leads to the Judges chamber and holding cells.>

(Defense
attorney) Not
guilty, your honor.

(Judge)

For the record, the defendant "Michael McCormick," has entered a plea of not guilty in case number, eighty-nine dash twentyone thirteen. Now the court orders that Mr. McCormick be remanded to the custody of the sheriff pending trial. Bond is set at twenty-five thousand dollars. Sheriff, place Mr. McCormick in custody.

< Mike looks over his shoulder as the sheriff ushers him to the holding cell.>
< He sees tears streaming down the faces of his brother and father.>

45. INT. (Detention center – Late evening)

< Mike is standing in the middle of a long line of prisoners. He is dressed in an orange prison jumpsuit. He is one of the smallest males in line.>
< The young giant watches the guard walk slowly pass them, inspecting the line.>

(Female V.O.)

Last call for chow! Last call for chow!

(Giant kid)

Yo, little nigga. What's up with them shoes?

< Mike faces him. Three others stand in front of him. One of them points to Mike's shoes.>

(Mike)

Nigga....

(Guard

V.O.)

Move it

five!

< They all glance over at the guard to see him point to the line that has advanced down the hall.>

(Giant kid)

Yeah, yeah, whatever man. We're movin'. We'll see your little ass later.

< He bumps Mike as he passes him.>

46. INT. (Youth dormitory)

< Mike enters through and closes the door. He looks back twice. A correctional officer exits an open door near the door Mike just used.>
< Mike approaches the man and whispers something. The guard points to a bucket with a mop positioned beside a small sanitation closet. Mike strolls towards the bucket.>

Ten minutes later

< The three goons who wanted Mike's shoes earlier are speedily walking towards Mike's cell. The leader frowns as he cracks his knuckles. One of the other bullies grins as he throws two short punches in the air.

< The mop bucket is positioned outside of Mike's open cell. The mop is in the bucket, but the wringer is missing.>

47. INT. (Mike's cell)

< The cell is eight by ten feet. It consists of an old toilet and sink. There is a metal bunk with a piss stained mattress on it. There is a blanket rolled up on the center of the bed.>

< Mike is positioned at the far wall facing the giant and his friend, who are blocking the doorway. One of Mike's hands is hidden behind his back. The giant moves swiftly towards Mike.>

(Giant kid)

Time for you to take this ass whooping kid!

< Mike smacks him across his chin with the mop wringer he had behind his back. The giant kid is knocked unconscious. He pounds the next one across the nose. He jumps sideways holding his broken nose. Before he can utter a word, Mike begins to beat him savagely with his weapon. The others flee as Mike continues to beat the guy after he hits the floor.>

< Three guards rush into the room with their two-way radios in hand. Mike does not stop pounding his prey. The leading guard cracks Mike across the back of his head with a flashlight. Mike's unconscious body slumps to the floor. After the guard handcuffs him behind his back, they drag him out of the cell by his shoulders.>

48. INT. (Solitary confinement – Two days later – Night)

< It is pitch black in his cell. Mike cannot even be seen on his bunk. Then, a sliver of light enters the room, after the guard opens the slot in the center of the door. The slot is used to slide the prisoner his food tray.

(Guard)

McCormick! Get up and get dressed! McCormick!

< Mike sits up in
bed.>

(Mike)

What
?

(Guard)

You got a visitor. Hurry up!

We don't have all day to put you in these chains!

49. INT. (Visiting area)

< Mike is seated at a wooden table with shackles around his ankles, and chains

wrapped around his waist. They are connected to the handcuffs around his wrist. His left eye is swollen and blackened.>

< A captain is seated near the entrance of the room. There is one other prisoner seeing his visitor. There are seven visiting tables with three chairs around them.>

(Mike)

Yo, can you loosen up the cuffs some? They're cutting off my fucking circulation!

Ima fuck around and pass out!

< The guard walks over to him.>

(Guard)

Listen McCormick, we heard about you, and I'm telling you that I won't let you be bothered up in here as long as you stay cool. Alright?

(Mike)

You got my word. Ima stay cool.

< He loosens the cuffs a little, then goes back to his seat.>

< Mike's eyes focus on a black woman who just entered the visiting room. She scans the room, searching for the person she came to see. He cannot look away as their eyes lock. Tears begin to stroll down her face. She covers her face as she cries uncontrollably>.

< She struts towards his table. He watches her every step. It is Trina, Mike's mother.>

(Trina)

Oh, my baby, my baby! I'm so sorry baby.

Look what time has done to you.

< She goes around the table, bends down, and hugs him.>

< They cry together, as she holds his face between her palms.>

(Trina)

I never should have let him have you.

I never should have let him have you baby. I love you so much.

(Mike)

I love you too mommy.

I've been trying to find you. Where you

been? (Trina)

Baby, I've been in Florida for the past eight years.

I was made to believe I wasn't needed.

(Mike)

Who made you believe that?

I needed you ever since the day you left.

(Trina)

I'm here now and that's what's important. I'm never going to leave you again. You are mine, and I love you so, so much.

Now, don't you worry about a thing.

(Mike)

Did you hear from Ron?

(Trina)

No sweetheart. He knows I'm in town though. I already paid the bail bondsman.

The man downstairs said that you should be released within the hour.

(Mike)
Okay
mommy.

(Trina)
Why do they have those chains on you?
You're no animal.

(Mike)
I'll tell you when we get home, okay?

(Trina)
Okay
baby.

(Mr. Stover)
Ma'am.

< A middle age white man with a crew cut, dark turtleneck, blue jeans, and cowboy boots walks in through the visitors door. >

< He glances around then strolls towards Mike's table. Trina spots him and stands to greet him.>

(Trina)
Mike, this is your bondsman. Are they releasing him now?

(Mr. Stover)
No ma'am, There's a problem. Mike, I'm Mr. William Stover. I paid your bond here, but these people say that a detainer has been lodged against you by New York City, for at least ten murders. Charges are also being pressed against you here for attempted murder.

(Trina)
No, that has to be a mistake. All of it.
< She looks at Mike. He lowers his head. Mr. Stover hands her a business card.>

(Mr. Stover)
If New York gives Mike a bond, give me a call. As of now, there is nothing I can do for you.

Mike, I wish you the best. Take care. I'll leave you to continue your visit.

< He leaves. She stoops back down in front of Mike. A tear escapes his eyes.>

(Mike)
Mommy, I had no choice in how I came up. I was forced out of Chauncey's and

grandma's house. All they did was talk bad about you, me, and Ron. Chauncey always called you names and he told me that you cheated on him when he went to jail down in Jamaica, before I was born.

That's how I found out Ron is my halfbrother. When Chauncey threw Ron out, I left too. Chauncey even said that he doesn't think I'm his son, because I'm dark skinned.

(Guard)

I'm sorry, ma'am, It's time for you to leave. His time is up.

< She nods her head and stands. The guard goes back to his seat.>

(Trina)

I'll be back tomorrow, so we'll talk then.
I love you baby, and I'll stand by you. I swear.

(Mike)

Everything will be alright mommy. I'm going to call Ron.
You'll see, it's going to be alright.

(Trina)

Baby, do you remember where I told you to seek heart, when you were a tiny baby?

(Mike)

I remember. You told me the "King of
the jungle." I remember everything
about you and the lion.

50. INT. (Telephone room – Day)

< Sunlight pours through the barred up windows. Mike is seated in a chair on the opposite side of the officer's desk. He's wearing leg and wrist chains. His eyes are still swollen.>

< A guard is seated on the other side of the desk watching Mike struggle to dial a number on the house phone. He uses his shoulder and neck to hold to phone to his ear.>

51. INT. (Ron's living room)

< A moving company is carrying away furniture through the open front door. The living room is half empty. The telephone on the floor starts ringing.>

< Rhonda runs into the house from the front door. She answers the phone.>

(Rhonda)

a)

Hello.

< Ron comes downstairs carrying a large cardboard box.>

< He stops near the door and looks to her. She holds the receiver toward him.>

(Rhonda)

Your brother is on the phone.

< Without making a sound, he uses his lips to tell her to hang up the phone. She places the phone skeptically to her ear. >

< Ron tosses his head side to side. Signaling her not to say anything. He nods his head

toward the phone signaling her to hang up. She looks confused, but she complies.>

52. INT. (Telephone room)
< Mike looks at the phone dumbfounded and confused, but he shakes it off and dials another number.>

(Kim's house)

< She holds the phone receiver to her ear.>

(Kim)

Hello, who is it? Oh...yeah, Ron came over here yesterday. He told me to tell you that he was closing down the spot. He said he was moving out of town, and that they found a big house to live in to raise the kids. You know, they're having another baby. He also said, that he was sorry, but he is retiring from the game. He was driving one of those new BMW 750's, and Rhonda had the kids in a new mini-van.

Yes baby, I love you too, but I've seen you all on the news. Derrick said, you ain't never coming home.

Listen baby, me and mommy decided that it's best I move on with my life.

53.INT. (Record store)

< Ron and another Rastafarian strolls into the small store. Ron is carrying a large white plastic bag. He scans the room. He spots a solidly built man dressed in a loose suit and carrying a thick leather briefcase. He is looking over a case full of cassette tapes.

< Ron nods in his direction. His companion followed him over to the man.>

(Man)

You got the stuff?

(Ron)

Yeah, me got it star.

< He opens the bag to reveal the stacks of kilos in the bag. The man swiftly snatches a nickel plated 357 Magnum from his pocket. >

< Before he could take aim, Ron's companion cowardly lowers himself to his knees and locks his hand on top of his head. The man aims the gun at Ron's head.>

(Man)

Get your muthafucking ass down, just like that blood clot and keep your mouth shut.

Now, lie down on your stomach.

< The gunman search the two men, and find a pistol in the waistline of Ron's companion. He smiles before tucking it into his waistline. Then he snatches up the bag and walks hastily towards the exit.>

< Ron leaps up and grabs the 22 caliber hand gun from under his hat and dreadlocks. He shoots the man four times in his back. The man collapses in the doorway. >

< Ron sprints over and snatches up the bag and the briefcase, and scurries out the door. His companion is in tow.>

54.INT. (Ron's apartment)

< Ron and the Rastafarian that was at the robbery with him, are seated at the kitchen table. The briefcase is open and is filled with stacks of money. The shopping bag is on the table beside the briefcase.>

< Ron stands and shuts the briefcase. He holds it down at his side.>

(Ron)

Yo, the old spot we used to work out of is empty now. You should be able to keep shit jumping with that. You got eight kilos in there homie. That's more than enough to get you up and running.

< The man stands and shakes Ron's hand.>

(Ron's friend)

Yeah Mon, good looking out.

55. INT. (Courthouse)

< Mike, Trina, and his lawyer stood facing the Judge. The prosecution was doing the same.>

< Kenny is seated on the bench behind his family.>

(Judge)

How do you plea?

(Mike)

Guilty, your honor.

(Judge)

I accept your plea of guilt, and I hereby sentence you to serve a prison term of no less than twenty-five years, and no longer than life. This sentence is to run concurrent with any other term you are serving. From this date forward, you are a ward of the state of New Jersey's department of correction until you are paroled or complete your sentence. Bailiff.

< Mike looks sadly at the floor. Trina wraps her arms around him, and buries her face in his neck and cries. Kenny has tears running down his face.>

56. INT. (Prison bus)

< Mike is seated in the center row of the sixty seat bus. He is staring at the fleeting road on the other side of his window. He has on a blue jumpsuit with state prisoner printed in big letters on the back. He is surrounded by grown men who are much older than himself. There are several ethnicities on the bus, but the majority are African-American.>

57. EXT. (Yardville penitentiary)

< The long dirty prison bus is waiting for the tall entrance gate to open. Hardened convicts are staring at the bus from their sanctioned off recreation yard.>

< Some of the men are lifting weights, punching the heavy bag, or just standing around in small groups.>

58. INT. (Prison unit – Night)

<The area has a long row of cells on both sides of the tier. There are several visible tables where the inmates are playing cards. The other men are just hanging on the tier, or in cells.>

< Mike exited his room in the center of one side of the wall. He has on boxer shorts and boots. A towel is draped over his shoulder, and he is holding a soap dish, shampoo, wash cloth, and a pair of boxer shorts in his hand. An older prisoner walks over to him.>

(Inmate)
Yo,
youngster.

(Mike)
What's
up?

(Inmate)
You're being watched.

< He nods his head towards a huge white prisoner with long hair and tattoos all over his body. He is standing against the wall with three other white inmates.>
< Mike looks at him. The man quickly looks at his unaware buddies.>

(Inmate)
It's good you're wearing your boots in the shower. If you got a shank, carry it with you, or take your chair.

(Mike)
I'm cool. That cracker ain't gonna jump here.
But, good lookin' out, yo.

< Mike walks down the hall toward the showers.>

59. INT. (Yardville Prison – Showers)
< There are several different small shower stalls, separated by four concrete walls with no doors.>
< Mike is under the water in the last stall. He notices the white man that was watching him on the tier, enter the middle shower stall. He glances at Mike as he stacks his shower gear on the wall.>
< Mike turns towards the exit end of his stall, and sees the old man walking away. Mike turns back to the shower, but notices the white man staring at him.>
< Mike grabs his shampoo and lathers his hair with it. He steps under the shower, but is facing the exit. He closes his eyes and sees the man creeping towards him. Once he is within striking distance, Mike picks up the chair and swings wildly at him. He misses as the man jumps backwards.>
< He swings the chair upward and it violently jerks the man's head backward. His body crashes to the floor. Instantly, Mike towers over him and pounds him with the chair.>

60. INT. (Yardville's solitary confinement unit – Mike's cell)
< Their cells are made of concrete with bars making up the front area. Mike is asleep on top of his bed.> (Omar V.O.)
Hey, youngblood!

< Mike's eyes pop open, but he does not move.>

(Omar V.O.)
We heard what you did in the unit where that crazy white cat tried to rape you. It's

about time somebody split him open. I want to show you something, son. Here, check this out, And I'll talk with you tomorrow.

< Mike limps over to the bars. He reaches out through the bars and accepts a dark green book. The book is backwards.>

(Mike)
Yeah,
thanks.

(Omar V.O.)
Just check it out, son. It can help you find yourself. By the way, I'm Omar. Everybody knows me around here. I'm the best lawyer on the yard. But, we'll talk about all that in the morning. Alright mike?

(Mike)
Yeah, but how do you know my name?

(Omar V.O.)
I read the newspapers every day, son. I'll talk to you in the morning.
It's the best book in the world.

(Mike)
Alright
.

< Mike sits on the edge of the bed. He flips the book over. He sees the words "HOLY QU'RAN" printed in bold gold letters. He starts reading the inner contents.>

61. INT. (Mike's cell – Next morning)
< Mike is seated on the edge of his bed reading the "HOLY QU'RAN." There is a tray on the bed. There is a scoop of half eaten scrambled eggs and a small milk carton.>

(Omar V.O. singing)
< Mike grabs the tray off his bed. He goes and sticks the tray in the slot in the center of the bars.>

(Mike)
Yo, Omar, you up over there?

(Omar V.O.)
Yeah, young blood. How you keeping up over there?

(Mike)
I'm cool. You know what? I was reading the book you gave me, and I like it.
I want to ask you some stuff about it.

(Omar V.O.)
So, you dig it, huh?

(Mike)
Yeah.
[79

(Omar V.O.)

That's good to hear, man. You need that book there. I'll answer any questions the best I can later. Right now, I got something else I want to rap with you about.

(Mike)
What's
up?

(Omar V.O.)

It's about being here. I can help you get off that twenty five to life sentence.
But, you have to trust me.

(Mike)

No offense to you Omar, but man, I don't trust nobody.

(Omar)

I like you, son. You remind me of myself twenty years ago, when I was about twenty two. You ain't like any thirteen year old I ever seen before. I know you, son. I've been down that road you're traveling and I want to help you get back out there. This ain't no place for nobody. Especially a teenager.

(Mike)

And just how do you think you can help me out, if you can't get yourself out of here?

(Omar)

That's just it, son. When I came in, I had three life sentences and forty years on top of that. But, I kept my mind on them books in the law library, and fought the case myself. I worked my time down to eighteen years, and I got twelve in on that. So, I think it's pretty safe to say that I did help myself quite a bit.

(Mike)

Yeah, you got a point there.

(Omar)

Listen, young blood, I don't write the law. What's right is right, and what's wrong is the fact that they got you sitting up here in Yardsville penitentiary, instead of a juvenile camp.

(Mike)

Yo, you telling me I ain't even supposed to be here?

(Omar)

Hell no! You ain't got no business up in here. They got so many laws against that, it's pathetic. I'm telling you, son, they know what they're doing. They figured you're a kid, so you won't double check their bullshit.

(Mike)

So, I can really get back out there?

(Omar)

Yeah. All you got to do is put a little trust in me and my work will speak for itself.

62. INT. (Prison chapel)

< The room is filled with Muslim prisoners. They are all standing on the edges of their prayer rugs, preparing to pray.>

< Mike is standing beside Omar. They all kneel and press their foreheads against the top of the rug in prayer.>

63. INT. (New Jersey courtroom – Day)

Mike stands before the judge that sentenced him with a look of confidence. He has a knitted Muslim cap on his head. His lawyer is at his side. The prosecutor is behind her table.

(Judge)

I see you changed your name since you were last before me. If you don't mind me asking, what exactly does "Wahid" mean?

(Unique)

It means "Unique" your honor.

(Judge)

Okay, Mr. Unique. The court has brought you here to correct the illegal sentence that was placed on you. This sentence is illegal. A twelve year old cannot be sentenced to serve an adult sentence, nor should you have been charged as an adult at twelve. So, I hereby eradicate that sentence. I am now resentencing you under juvenile status, to a term of juvenile life. This term will end when you turn eighteen. Until then you will be housed in the Yardville penitentiary juvenile unit.

< The judge signals the end of the hearing, by the banging of his gavel.

64. INT. (Yardville penitentiary – Five years later)

< Unique is now a taller, athletically built kid. He is dialing a phone number on the wall phone in his unit.

SPLIT SCREEN:

65. INT. (Samone's bedroom)

< She answers the phone.

(Samone)

Hello? Yes, I will accept the call. Hi baby!

(Unique)

What's up? I called earlier to let you know that I'll be home Friday.

(Samone)

Oh, baby.... For real?

(Unique)

Yeah.

(Samone)

[83

Why you sound so sad
then? (Mike)

[83

Because I learned we have something to talk about.

(Samone)
What do you
mean?

(Mike)
Don't act like you don't know what's up all of a sudden.
Tell me about your man.

(Samone)
Oh, shit baby. Look, I wasn't trying to keep that from you or nothing like that. You have to understand that you had a long time to do, and I got so lonely, but still stayed by your side. Even though I have Bill here with me, I want you to understand that I love you still, but I'm not in love with you anymore, Unique.

(Mike)
And what the fuck does that mean?

(Samone)
Unique, don't make this harder for me than it already is.
Baby, I still got your back, and I want our son to be proud that we still get along

(Mike)
Well, I'm letting you know that I'm still on my ass in love with you, and when I come home, I'll give you two months to decide who you want to be with. Either way, there won't be any hard feelings, Samone.

Alright?

(Samone)
Yeah, Unique. I hear you, baby.

(Mike)
Alright, then. I'll see you when I see you.
Bye.

SCENE ENDS:

66. EXT. (Yardville penitentiary – Day)
< Unique walks out of the prison carrying a small bag under his arm.
< Chauncey and Kenny are standing beside a black Ford Explorer, smiling.
< Kenny embraces him.

(Kenny)
Damn, Unique, it's good to have you back little brother.

(Unique)
Thanks, man. It's just so good to be back out here.
I still can't believe this hell is over.

< Chauncey stares into Unique's eyes as he shakes his hand.

(Chauncey)
Are you sure it's over?

(Mike)
We'll
see.

(Chauncey)
What are you planning to do with yourself?

(Unique)
Right now, I'm just going to lay back and see where it is I should be.
I've got a few things to take care of before I can honestly say what I'll be doing in
the future.

(Chauncey)
Well, you're a man now, and I trust your experience has changed
some things. They call you Unique now, and with a name like that
comes certain actions.
I hope you'll do the right thing out there.

(Mike)
Yeah, I'll be alright. Yo, Kenny, you can drop me off at the bus station.
I can get to New York from there.

(Kenny)
Don't you want to go check out grandma?

(Unique)
Grandma knew where I was for five whole years, and she never came to check
me out.
She'll see me when I'm ready to see her.
Let's get away from here.

< They stroll towards the truck.>

67. INT. (Apartment of illegal gun sellers – N.Y.C.)
< Unique is inspecting an automatic nine millimeter. He cocks the gun back, and
stuffs it in his waistline.>
< He smiles approvingly at the teenager and older male who are standing in front of
him.>

(Teen)
Yo, you sure you ain't escape?

(Unique)

Didn't I tell you no, three times already?

Nigga, I beat those bodies, and my man got my time cut to juvenile life.

Now, take this money before I say, you beat.

< Unique slams his money into the boy's hand.>

68.INT. (Ms. Simmons house)

< Unique is facing the closed front door. He raises his fist to knock, but the door swings open.>

< A pleasant looking chubby woman stands in the doorway with a look of astonishment.>

< She hugs him and kisses him on the cheek>.

(Ms. Simmons)

Hi, baby! When did you get home?

(Unique)

Today. How you been doing?

(Ms. Simmons)

I've been doing pretty well. Welcome home Mike.

(Mike)

My name is Unique now, Ms. Simmons.

(Ms. Simmons)

That's such a pretty name. Come on in.

69.INT. (Ms. Simmons house – Living room)

< Unique follows her into the house.>

(Unique))

I stopped by of course, to say hello, and I was hoping you can help me find Ron.

(Ms. Simmons)

Oh, child, you came to the right place. I know he will be glad to see you're back. As a matter of fact, he's right downstairs in the basement, fixing the dryer. You can go right on down there and surprise him. Rhonda and the kids are upstairs.

(Unique)

I'll just go surprise Ron first.

(Ms. Simmons)

Okay. You know the way down there. It really is wonderful to see you home.

<Unique smiles and heads for the basement.>

70.INT. (Ms. Simmons basement)

< Ron is seated on top of the dryer, drinking a beer. He looks up and sees Unique walking towards him. His eyes widen in fear as he drops his beer.

< Unique smiles wickedly and pulls out his pistol.>

(Unique)

Hey, big bro! What's wrong?

< Ron jumps off the dryer, and backs into the far wall, keeping his eyes on Unique's gun.>

< With a quizzical look, Unique rubs his chin with his free hand.>

(Unique)

What are you talking about Ron?

Are you referring to the way you played me?

(Ron)

I, I, I didn't play you, man.

Something came up.

(Unique)

What the fuck you mean, something came up, Nigga?

(Rhonda

V.O.) Ron!

< The stairs are squeaking from her footsteps, as she comes down the stairs.>

< She freezes when she sees Unique frowning at her shivering husband.>

< Unique shields the gun behind his leg.>

(Rhonda)

What's going on down here? Mike, when did you get home?

What's wrong?

(Unique)

What's wrong? Why don't you ask your husband, what's wrong. Tell your lady, what's wrong, bro. Tell her how you ripped me off and left me with nothing. Tell her how you emptied out my apartment, took my dope, stole my money, and ran with it instead doing what I asked and trusted you to do. Tell her the reason you've been avoiding me, is because you're a lying snake. Tell her!

(Rhonda)

Baby? What is Mike taking about?

(Unique)

It's Unique. My name is Unique now.

(Ron)

Listen, sweetheart. Remember when we moved out of New York?

(Rhonda)

Sure, I do. What about it?

(Ron)

Everything we took belonged to Unique. The money, the furniture, and the drugs I sold. He gave it all to me to look after and take care of, until he got home. He wanted me to do some things and I didn't.

(Rhonda)

Oh, baby. Why didn't you tell me?

(Ron)

I don't know hon. I don't know.

< She walks up to her husband.>

(Rhonda)

Everything was
Unique's?

(Unique)

Yeah, everything was Unique's. He took everything I had, and ran the fuck off.
Now, he has to answer for it. Why did you betray me, bro?

< Ron is trembling uncontrollably.>

< He clasps his hands around his face, bracing for a bullet.>

(Ron)

Oh, my god! Please, little
bro. Don't kill me in front
of my wife.

(Unique)

Shut the fuck up! Don't open your muthafucking mouth. I advise you to listen closely and remember what I'm about to say, because it's the only thing that's going to keep you breathing when I leave here. You understand?

(Ron)

Okay,
okay.

(Unique)

The reason you played me is real simple. You were in a tight situation living in the rotten slums, and you had a choice between pushing drugs for your little brother or, taking his property. You wanted to make a home for your kids, and the baby you had on the way. You didn't mean me no harm at all, you just had to do what was best for your family.

That's it, and that's all. If it was the other way around, I would be forced to blow your fucking brains out. Now, you owe your life to your kids, nigga. You got a pass on your life.

< Unique stuffs his gun back into his waistline, and strolls toward the stairs.>

71.INT. (Unique's grandmother's house)
< Unique is walking towards the closed front door. He pulls the curtain back and sees a balding white man in a cheap suit in front of him.>

(Unique)

Yo, who you want?

(Mr. Kennedy)

I'm David Kennedy, Michael's parole officer.

< Unique opens the door. He extends
his hand.>

(Unique)

So, you're my P.O?

< The man smiles and shakes his
hand.>

(Mr. Kennedy)

Yeah. I went to your sister Ronnette's house, but she told me that
you were here. Did you know that your parole address was
switched to her house instead of here?

(Unique)

No, I didn't know that. When did it happen?

(Mr. Kennedy)

About an hour ago. When we called there, we sensed that she wasn't very happy
with the idea, so we called other family members. She has no issues with you staying
there.

(Unique)

That's cool. What's up with the job you got for me?

72. INT. (Fast food restaurant – Two months later)

< Unique is dressed in the company's uniform. He is busy working as a salad prep.>

73. (Ronnette's house – Kitchen-A month later)

< Unique is seated across the table from Ronnette. He looks saddened and withdrawn.>

(Unique)

I've been busting my ass around that spot and they still ain't promoted me yet.
I know it's because of my record.

(Ronnette)

Unique, it's only been a month. Promotions take time.

< Unique hops up from his
chair.>

(Unique)

Yo, fuck that! This kid started the same day as me and this other kid, and they
promoted him last week. Yo, I asked the manager when I might step up. He told me, I
ain't ready.

(Ronnette)

See, it takes time, like I told you.

(Unique)

Yo, they tripping. Me and the big teeth kid is chilling. He's a fuck up though, so I see why they're playing him. But I do what the fuck they tell me.

(Ronnelle)
Just be
patient.

73. INT. (Fast food restaurant – Two weeks later)
< A teenager with large teeth smiles and pounces around, as all the other employees except Unique, cheer him on. The manager is an older black man with an old white shirt on. The smiling boy has on an identical, but new shirt as the man.
< Unique frowns, snatches the company cap off his head, and slings it to the floor.
< He walks out as the others curiously stare on.

74. INT. (Ronnelle's house – Living room – Two months later)
<Unique hands the woman a small stack of money. He beams proudly at her.>
< She laughs and caresses his cheek.>

75. INT. (Spanish Tony's apartment -Living room – two months later)
< Unique follows a Spanish male into the spacious living room.>
< Unique stops in the center of the floor. He holds his hands crossed in front of him, down by his waist.> A gesture to show he's not a threat.>
< Tony and another man are seated around a large table at the far wall. There are medium sized boxes under the table.>
< The two men watch Unique with suspicion.>

(Unique)
What's up
y'all?

< Tony gets up. When he reaches Mike, he extends a closed fist.>

(Tony)
Que pasa, mi Amigo?

(Unique)
Not too much, homie. I'm just trying to start over out here.

(Tony)
So, mi Amigo, we got no old bones? Are they all buried?

(Unique)
They're definitely buried, homie. I got no beef.
I'm here to do business.

< The Spanish men begin to laugh. Tony and Unique share a quick embrace.>

(Tony)

Well, bro, you've come to the right place. Everything you need, we got it.

And if we don't, we sure as hell know where to find it.

< He gestures for Unique to follow him over to the table.>

< They both sit down.>

(Tony)

Look around you bro. Everything you see here and all of our new positions in the hood is your work. We all know it, and we're going to make sure that you know it. Just name it, and you got it coming.

(Unique)

Well, Tony. All I got on me is a hundred dollars. I want you to give me however much cocaine you think that is worth, without making me feel like I came here and stole something. I want to get back to jersey, and get my hustle on. You know what I mean?

(Tony)

Si, Si, I know what you mean. I'll hook you right up.

(Unique)

Cool. If I like the product, all of my business will be brought here.

(Tony)

That sounds good.

< Tony retrieves one of the boxes from under the table. He lifts out a kilo of cocaine and a scale.>

< He pours a nice size hill of it on the plate on top of the scale.>

(Tony)

That's seven and a half grams, bro. Three and a half for your money, and three and a half for our appreciation. You'll love it because it's the purest shit out there right now. So, when you push it, you know where to come for more. You're welcome here bro.

76. INT. (Paul's car – New Jersey – Evening)

< Paul sees Unique sitting on a bench outside of the bus station. He is listening to an old woman talk.>

< Paul honks his horn. Unique recognizes him. Unique waves at the woman and sits down in the car beside Paul.

(Paul)

Let's go get paid, my nigga.

77. INT. (Kathy's house)

< Kathy opens the door and smiles at Paul and a barely visible Unique.>

< She is an extremely voluptuous brown skinned woman in her late thirties.>

(Kathy)

Hey, Paul. What's up?

< They follow her into her cheap, but pleasant looking living room.>

(Paul)
Not much girl.

(Kathy)
So, who's your friend?

(Paul)
Oh, that's my boy, Unique. He's the one I was telling you about.

(Kathy)
Oh, okay. He's the one who was locked up with you.
Well, Unique, how are you? I'm Kathy.

(Unique)
I'm doing pretty decent, Kathy. Nice to meet you.

(Kathy)
Well, I heard about you and your money, and believe me, it's floating around
here like crazy.
All you got to do is catch it.

78. INT. (Tony's apartment)
< Unique walks over to the table as Tony stands.>
< One of Tony's partners is trailing behind Unique.>

(Unique)
What can I get for this five hundred?
< Tony laughs and shakes his
head.>

(Tony)
You've only been gone for an hour.

(Unique)
Business is
booming.
<He hands him the money.>

(Tony)
I see. Come on over to the table. Let me hook you up.

79. Ext. (Kathy's house – Back area – Night)
< Paul and Unique are standing under the porch light and selling crack cocaine
to nine different crackheads.>
< After serving the majority of them, Unique smirks and hunches his shoulders at

one of the men not served.>

[...]

(Unique)
We just ran out, yo.

(Crackhead)
Come on, yo. I want to buy thirty twenties, yo.

(Unique)
Come back in about fortyfive minutes. I got to re-up.

(Unique)
Fortyfive, yo.
(Chuckling)

(Crackhead)
Ahight.

80. INT. (Tony's house)
< Unique dumps stacks of money from his Louis Vuitton bag on to the table in front of Tony.>

(Unique)
That's seventeen thousand. What can I get with that?

(Tony)
Yo, you rollin! Six days ago you dropped a hundred on me.
Now, you got kilo money.

81. INT. (Kathy's house – Night)
< Uniques' eyes pop open. He looks down and see's Kathy performing oral sex on him.>
< Their eyes meet with mutual delight. He grips her head, as his body tenses, his eyes close.>
< Seconds later, he exhales a deep breath, and opens his eyes again.>
< She stands, and calmly adjusts the bath towel she is wearing.>

(Kathy)
Listen, sweetheart. I couldn't help doing that.
I've been wanting you since we met. I want you to stay here with me.

(Unique)
That's some strange shit with the dick and all that, but, I can overlook it.
About me staying here, I'm here all day every day. Hell, I'm trying to get this paper.

(Kathy)
That's not what I mean, and you know it.

(Unique)

[...]

[...]

Well, whatever it is, you need to stop tripping.

[...]

[...]

(Kathy)

Unique, what the fuck else can I do?
Don't you see that I care about you? I love you.

(Unique)

Kathy, baby, I don't have time for that.

(Kathy)

Well, check this out. I want you to make a choice. You either move all your things in here, or go sell your dope somewhere else. I'm tired of this shit. I'm going out of my way for you because of how I feel about you, and you don't even give a fuck. All you do is – (He leaps up and cut's her off)

(Unique)

Bitch, hold the fuck up! I ain't tryin' to hear this sucker ass shit you talkin' up in here! You acting like I'm fuckin' you over or some shit. Bitch, don't I pay you every damn day that I make money in here? Huh?

That new house you went to scope out yesterday, who made that happen, huh? I don't give a fuck about you Kathy. All I'm here to do is stack my money, and I would think you would chill out and let me do it. If you was tryin' to give a nigga some pussy, all you had to do was make it happen. That love shit is out of bounds and you know it. Bitch!

< A solitary tear rolls down her
cheek.>

(Kathy)

You little muthafucka. I don't know what's wrong with you and I don't want to find out now. You can do whatever you feel like around here. You don't have to leave, and if you don't give a fuck about me, you don't have to. We can just leave it at that.

<She storms up the staircase.

(Kathy V.O.)

And I don't want no more of your fucking money!

< He hears a door slam. Unique stares at the staircase.

< He strolls towards them.

82. INT, (Kathy's house – Upstairs hallway)

< Unique is standing in front of the closed door. It slowly opens.>

< Kathy appears in the doorway. She wipes away her tears. She's still wearing a towel.>

(Kathy)

What do you want, Unique?

Is there some other kind of way to make me feel like shit you forgot to express
downstairs?

(Unique)

Nah, Kathy. It ain't even about that. I just need to talk to you.

[...]

[...]

< He slides past her and leads her by the hand, over to the bed.>
< He sits on the edge of it, never letting go of her hand.>

[...]

[_ .

(Unique)

Listen to me. I just got done doing time and nobody gave a shit about me, but my mother and god. Nobody ever loved me before, even though love was always the first thing out of everybody's mouth when a nigga is getting his money. I don't trust nobody Kathy, not even you.

It's nothing personal, that's just the way I've had to be all my life. Nobody really cares about me. People don't love people. People love things. That's the way it is for me. Love doesn't exist anymore.

(Kathy)

Baby, love exists. You just got to let somebody give it to you. Everybody ain't the same, Unique. I really care about you. I've thought about it hard for the past couple of weeks and I know it can work if you let it. You don't need this shit. I don't need it. I've got my own money and a college degree. I know you're capable of much more than what you've chosen for yourself. Unique, we can leave this all behind and make it.

(Unique)

I see what you're saying. We'll talk more about this in the morning, okay?
Right now, I want to give you something.

<She
smiles.>

(Kathy)
What?

< He starts kissing her hand. He unfastens her robe, and lets it fall to the floor. He goes down to his knees, grabs her around the waist, leans forward, and kisses her navel. He circles it with his tongue. He slowly stands as he glides his tongue up the center of her body. He rewets his tongue in her mouth. He turns her towards the bed. She sits and lies back. He rips his shirt off and tosses it. She reaches for him and wiggles her fingers. He goes to her, and they kiss passionately as she unzips and pulls his pants down.>

< He bites gently on her bottom lip. He kisses down her neck and flickers his tongue along her collar bone. He runs his tongue down the center of her torso, until it disappears into the juices of her honey cup. Her breasts heave upward, as her head drops back and her mouth opens to release the silent pleasure.>

83. INT. (Kathy's bedroom – Early the next morning)

< Kathy rolls over in bed and reaches out her hand to grab hold of somebody, but that somebody is no longer there.>

< Her eyes open. She buries her face in the pillow beside her, and cries.>

84. INT. (Abandoned building – N.Y.C. – Harlem)

< Unique is standing in the filthy hallway drinking a soda as he watches two men complete the installation of a steel door on the frame of the main apartment. Trash

[_ .

[...]

is scattered near the immediate area inside the apartment.>

<The men close the door, then reopen it. Unique pulls a bankroll of cash from his pocket. He peels off a few bills and hands them to the workers.>

[...]

[...]

85. INT. (Tony's apartment – Night)
< Unique is standing at the side of the table watching Tony stack three kilos into a gym bag. In front of Unique is a pile of money stacked up.>

(Tony)
Bro, you really got your new spot rolling. That's good, but you make too many trips to the crib. So, from now on, call me and I'll let you know when to stop by.

(Unique)
Cool.

86. EXT. (Abandoned building – Morning)
< Unique is sitting in the front of his building. A local teen is walking down the sidewalk in his direction.> An old Chevy Caprice classic rolls slowly down the street, and pulls up beside the teenager. The driver is a rough looking woman.>

(Woman)
Hey, baby. Come here for a minute.

< She stops the car. The engine continues to hum. The teen goes and leans in the passenger window.>

(Teen)
Yo, sweetheart. What you need? You name it, I got it.

(Woman)
I just got paid, and I'm trying to cop. I need two hundred worth.
I can't find anybody out right now. Can you hook me up with a contact? Mine is dry.

(Teen)
Oh, shit baby girl. You ain't got nothing to worry about. Flash me the cash, I'll show you the purest shit it town.

(Woman)
Sure,
baby.

<She pulls two hundred dollar bills out of her bra, and shows him. He smiles.>

(Woman)
Let me see what you got.

(Teen)
Cool.

< He pulls out a small zip-lock bag from inside his jacket. He pours ten onto his hand,

[...]

[...]

then reaches his open hand into the car.>

< She suddenly slaps up the bottom of his hand, and the drugs go flying into the air.>

<She speeds off and the teen chases after the car. Unique bursts into laughter.>

[...]

[...]

(Teen)

Crackhead bitch! If I catch you around here again, I'll smoke you!

(Unique)

Fucking new Jacks around here faking.

(Local boy V.O.)

Nah. Nigga! The only one around here faking is you!

<Unique looks to his right and sees three fashionably dressed men eight feet away. He stands as the teenager walks off in the opposite direction>.

(Local boy)

You that nigga out here steppin' on our toes. We know what's goin' down over here homie.

We tellin' you nicely that you can't hustle over here no more.

You fuckin' up our shit and that's a violation. We advise you to step off, and do it quick.

Next time it won't be so nice.

< The man on his left raises his sweater, revealing the handle of an old revolver.

(Unique)

Yo, check this out homie

If I can't hustle around here, then ain't no nigga qualified to. Understand?

<Unique swiftly yanks a gun from his waist. The men sprint up the walk.>

<He fires several shots over their heads.>

87. EXT. (Apollo theater)

< The sing reads: Eric B & Rakim 8:00 pm tonight. Ft. A Tribe called Quest and Nice & Smooth.>

<Unique is standing in front of the girl in the ticket booth. He slides a fifty dollar bill through the slot.>

(Unique)

Can I have two tickets for tonight's show? You can keep the change.

<She blushes and hands him two tickets. He nods his head, and strolls past his white Mitsubishi Cordia into the shoe store opposite his car.>

88. INT (Shoe store)

< Unique is scanning the wall of tennis shoes that are on display.>

< He stops in front of the latest pair of Air Jordan's.>

< He picks up the shoes for inspection, then glances around for some help.>

< Another customer seems to be waiting.>

[...]

[...]

(Unique)

Hey, excuse me! I need some assistance out here!

[...]

[. . .

(Deedee V.O.)
Hold on, one second! I'm coming!

< A stunning woman in her early twenties, comes out from the storage room with a tennis shoe box.>

< She sees Unique and blushes.>

(Deedee)
Hi, can I help you?

(Unique)
Yeah sweetheart, you can help me. I want these shoes right here.

(Deedee)
Sure, what
size?

< The other customer looks at her with a look of disbelief.>

(Unique)
Size nine, please. And if you don't mind me asking, what is your name?

(Deedee)
My name is Deedee. What's yours?

(Customer)
Miss, what's up with my shoes?

< She looks over and signals him to wait a minute. He frowns at her, then storms out of the store.>

< She looks to Unique. He checks his pager as it buzzes.>

(Unique)
My name is Unique. Do you know anyone who would take offense to you going out somewhere with me tonight?

(Deedee)
No, Unique. I don't have a man. At least, not yet.

(Unique)
Well, I like you Deedee. And I want you to allow me to pick you up tonight.
That is, if you don't already have any plans.

(Deedee)
I don't see anything wrong with that.
When I get back with your shoes, I'll give you my number.

[. . .

[...]

89.INT. (Unique's white Mitsubishi Cordia)

[...]

[. . .

< Unique is driving along the streets. He punches in a phone number on the car phone.>
< He has on the speaker phone. The phone rings twice before it is answered.>

(Samone V.O.)
Hello?

(Unique)
Yo, this is Unique. I just got your page. What's up?

(Samone)
Not too much. Look, Maleek has been pressing me all day to call you for him.
Hold on a second, here he is.

(Maleek V.O.)
Yo, dad, what's up? I got three stickers in head start yesterday! You can scratch 'em and they all smell like stuff! Anyway, when you coming to pick me up again? We had fun the last time and Roger wants to come with us again. He said, you're cool. I scraped my leg playing basketball at Juey's house, but it ain't nothing. Oh yeah, dad, thanks for my new bike. I like it even with them wheels on the back tires.

(Unique)
Laughing: You're welcome little homie. I see you been real busy.
You know, we got to hook up and start getting you some clothes for school.

(Maleek V.O.)
Yeah, dad. I wanna be fly like you.

(Unique)
So, homie, when's the last time you talked to your brother?

(Maleek V.O.)
Last week, dad. Miss Kim is real mean, but she brought Raheem over and we had fun and stuff. Miss Kim didn't stay because I don't think she likes mommy. But, mommy wants me and Raheem to be together like brothers are supposed to be.

(Unique)
That's right homie, is your mother still around?

(Maleek V.O.)
Yeah, dad. You want me to give her the phone?

(Unique)
Yeah, I love you homie.

(Maleek V.O.)
I love you too, dad. Bye.

[. . .

[...]

(Samone)

Yeah?

(Unique)

Is everything straight with you?

(Samone V.O.)

Yeah, everything is about as good as it can be.
I just need to move away and get myself a house.

(Unique)

Oh yeah, what's up with Billie?

(Samone V.O.)

We're just chilling over here as usual. He's alright.

(Unique)

Let me speak to him

(Samone V.O.)

Oh, hell no Unique. You don't want to do nothing but start some shit.

(Unique)

Come on now, Samone. How long has it been?

(Samone V.O.)

About four months since you found out.

(Unique)

I ain't tripped yet. You of all people should know that I ain't got time for no
simple shit.

I ain't about to start beefin' with some nigga over some bitch.

(Samone V.O.)

Hold on Unique. I'll give him the phone. Remember, you promised not to start
anything.

(Unique)

Ahight.

(Billie V.O.)

Yo, Unique! What's up man?

(Unique)

Nothing much, homie. Just trying to see what you and Samone are into tonight.
I got a spot we can all go kick it at. What you think? You down with it?

(Billie V.O.)

I'm cool with it, man. But, you know, I got to see if Samone is down. Hold on a
minute.

[...]

[...]

Yo, Unique. She bitched a little, but she's down. What time you wanna roll?

[...]

[. . .

(Unique)

About eleventhirty. Ahight, I'm out.

(Billie V.O.)

Ahight,
later.

90. INT. (Apollo theater)

< Eric B & Rakim are rocking the crowd as they spit their hit tune, "Paid in full.">

< Unique and Dee are in their seats reciting the song along with the rappers.>

< The rappers end their performance, and the crowd begins to file out.>

(Sandra V.O.)

Hey, Deedee! What's up girl?

< Deedee spots her friend. They hug, and Sandra notices Unique.>

(Sandra)

So, girl...who is this?

(Deedee)

This is Unique. We just met. Unique, this is my friend, Sandra.

(Unique)

Nice to meet you.

(Sandra)

You too. Girl, let me get back over to Felix, before I have to kick some bitches ass tonight.

They're on him tonight.

(Dee-
dee)

Okay,
girl.

< Sandra leans over to Dee's
ear.>

(Sandra)

Whispers: Girl, he's a keeper. But, tone that smile down a notch, before you break your fucking face.

(Dee-dee)

Whatever,
girl.

91. INT. (Unique's car)

< Unique double parks in front of Deedee's building. He looks over at her.>

[. . .

[...]

(Unique)
You have a good time?

(Dee-dee)

[...]

[. _

Yes, I had a very nice time. Thanks for taking me out. When will I see you again?

< He writes his number down on a piece of paper, and hands it to her. He glances at his watch.>

(Unique)
Hit me whenever.

< She nods in agreement. She leans over, kisses him on the cheek, and lets herself out.>

92. INT. (Popular N.Y.C. club – Midnight)

< Unique enters the club with Samone and Billie in tow. Many people wave or shake Unique's hand as he makes his way to a booth in the back corner.>

< The club is packed as the latest Kid Capri mixtape is blasting.>

< Unique and his guests take their seats in the booth. The club's owner comes over, hugs Unique, and hands him a chilled bottle of champagne.>

(DJ Starchild V.O.)
I'd like to give a shout out to my homie, Unique! What up, yo!
Welcome home! This next joint goes out to you!

< Eric B & Rakim's "I ain't no joke," starts booming from the speakers.>

< Unique smiles and pumps his fist in the air. Samone looks displeased. Billie is nodding his head to the beat.>

< Unique leans forward, and looks at him.>

(Unique)
You want some coke?

(Billie)
What you
got?

< Unique glances over to Samone who is staring at him. He pulls out a dollar bill, fills it with coke so she can see, and hands it to Billie.>

< Billie takes it and begins to sniff the powder.>

< Samone is angrily biting her lower lip. Billie offers the bill back to Unique, which still has some coke on it.>

(Unique)
Nah, man. I don't sniff that shit.

(Billie)
All this for me?

93. INT. (Unique's car – New Jersey)

< Unique double parks the car in front of Samone's mother's house.>

< Billie is seated on the passenger side, Samone is seated in the back.>

(Billie)
You got some more coke? All I got is ten dollars.

[. _

[...

< Billie pulls the money out of his pocket.>

< Unique looks into the rearview mirror at Samone who is visibly fuming.>

(Unique)
Give me the
bill.

< He hands him the single and the ten dollar bill.>

< Unique pockets the ten, pours a nice amount of coke into the single then, gives it back to Billie.>

(Billie)
Damn. If I give you a twenty, will you double that?

(Unique)
For you, I think I'll do that homie.

(Billie)
Samone, give me a twenty.

(Samone)
For that shit? You got that shit backwards, Billie, for real.
I don't know what your problem is tonight.

< She exhales forcefully, then she hands him the twenty.>

< He hands Unique the money.>

< Unique gives the twenty dollars back, plus a stack of money to her.>

(Samone)
Fuck this
bullshit!

< She throws the money towards the front, it scatters as it hits the windshield.>

< Unique tries desperately not to smile.>

< Billie is scrambling to pick up the money.>

< Unique yanks out a gun and aims it at Billie's head.>

< Billie stops, and then begins to nervously shiver.>

(Unique)
Nigga, don't make me kill your ass in this
car tonight. Put that shit down, and get the
fuck out. Now!!

(Uniqu

[...

[...]

< Billie quickly exits the car.>

< Samone is so angry she does not move.>

< She can only sit and stare at Unique, as tears run down her face.>

(Uniqu

[...]

[...]

So, this is what you left me for? An old ass coke head who is broke as hell, and old enough to be your father, while you live at home with your momma.

< He shakes his head and laughs arrogantly.>

< She does not respond. She hangs her head in shame then leaves the car.>

< Unique accomplishes his goal, but the taste in his mouth is bittersweet.>

94. INT. (Tony's apartment)

< Unique is seated on the couch. He looks up at the clock on the wall. It's 12:15 am.>

< Tony walks into the front room.>

< Unique stands and shakes hands.>

(Unique)
Whats' up
homie?

(Tony)

Well, let me fill you in on why you're here. As you already know, everybody down the hill comes up the hill to cop, then all the runners take them to a number of different spots up here to cop. It's been that way for years now.

Down the hill you have the blacks in Harlem, while you have the Dominicans up the hill in Washington heights. Dominicans haven't been down the hill to hustle, but the blacks are free to come up the hill to cop weight. You following?

(Unique)
Yeah, I'm hearing you.

(Tony)

Okay, my friend. That's the reason why you are here today. I want to set up shop down the hill, so it will be easier for the blacks to cop my weight down there without having to come up the hill and spread all this money and info around to all these bosses. This will also keep the heat down and lessen all of our chances of being fucked by the feds. This is where you come in.

(Unique)
I'm
listening.

(Tony)

I want you to move more weight directly to the brothers in Harlem. You will control the product down the hill, while I supply you from up here. I feel nobody is better for the job than you. I will supply you all the weight you need on consignment.

(Unique)
I think it's a good idea, and I know you are talking about a shit load of kilos. The block I'm hustling on has four buildings moving the better part of three keys a day each. Then you have coke spots from 110th all the way to 155th on 8th avenue. What you are describing is a power move with endless possibilities.

(Unique)

[...]

[...]

(Tony)
You up for
it?

(Uniqu

[...]

[...]

Definitely. As long as we can keep the supply and demand popping.

(Tony)

Don't worry about that part of it Unique.

I guarantee that everything you need to move, you will have. I'll see to that personally.

(Unique)

One thing I would like to know, is why did you choose me to be your right hand man?

(Tony)

You got this shit in your blood homie. You were holding your shit down at thirteen yo. Now that you're older and back on your feet a little, I know it's only a matter of time before you become a certified boss around here. So, I have to plan to make that happen, so that you becoming a boss doesn't have an adverse effect on my moves, feel me?

At the same time, it's giving you the opportunities to be more than just a capo. Together, we can lock down a major part of this game and make everybody happy.

(Unique)

Ahight, I'm with that. But, let's take it slow and properly process this. I want to kick off my block first, so that we can get the feel of this shit.

So, I'll need about fifty keys to hold down my block for maybe, a week. I got plenty of safe storage place in my building, so that won't be an issue.

(Tony)

Cool.

(Unique)

Now, let's reason about prices. The price up here for a kilos is twelve grand.

So, I have to sell it for less than that down the hill. What you think?

(Tony)

I feel you. I'll give each kilo to you for seven grand. You can sell it for whatever you want down on the hill.

(Unique)

I can work with that. When do you want to start?

(Tony)

Shit. Right now, if you have no plans.

(Unique)

e) Lets' roll.

95. EXT. (Local park – Early morning)

[...]

[...]

< Unique and the three men he shot at recently, are gathered around a picnic table.>
< Unique is dressed in army fatigue pants and a matching jacket. On his feet are beige Timberlands firmly laced up, and he dons a pair of tinted designer shades. A black skull cap is on his head.>

[...]

[_ .

(Unique)

I know we've had our differences over the past few weeks, hustling for control of the block. I have a proposal for future business dealings that we all can benefit from. That way, we can all have a mutual respect and understanding.

< Unique studies the group. Their facial expressions are passive, but curious.>

(Unique)

How much y'all payin for kilos?

(Hustler 1)

Twelve
grand.

(Unique)

Tell you what. We'll knock that price tag down to ten grand, as long as we have an understanding amongst each other. Y'all down with that?

(Hustler 2)

Fuck, yeah. I'm down with that!

< The others nod in agreement.>

(Hustler 3)

Is that ten grand for a key of powder, or a key of rocks?

(Uniqu

e)

Powde

r.

(Hustler 1)

How much will you charge to rock it up, the way you be rocking up yo shit?

(Unique)

Eleven grand a key, if I have to cook it up.

(Hustler 1)

Deal!

< The others concur, and he shakes their hands.>

96. INT. (Tony's apartment – Night)

< Tony opens the door and Unique walks in. They bump fists.>

(Tony)

Is everything alright, my friend?

[_ .

[...]

(Unique)

[...]

[_ _

Perfection. Everything is sold, and I've got seven hundred grand down in the van.

(Tony)

That's good to hear, homie!

(Unique)

I'm going to leave the van with you.

That way, you can fill it up with a hundred more keys, then roll it down to me.

(Tony)

Listen bro, since you've stepped up your flow to a hundred kilos in three weeks, I think you should take some time off and get some rest. I'll see you whenever you come back to see me. I know this shit is tiring. We're ahead right now, so we both can afford a break.

(Unique)

Yeah, that does sound good. Alright. I'mma do that and I'll hit you when I'm ready.

< Tony smiles and nods in agreement. They shake hands.>

97. INT. (Dapper Dans' Custom interior – Morning)

< Unique is walking around his car inspecting the car's new makeover.>

< There is a custom made "MCM" cover on the tail of the car, with a matching one on the front grill.>

< On the tail, there are gold letters spelling "Peace God" on the front grill, the same style lettering spells out "Unique.">

< The interior of the car has been done in the same custom "MCM" leather as the grill and tail.>

< "BBS" rims on Perilli tires completes the makeover.>

< Unique turns to the repair men and the owner of the shop.>

(Unique)

Yeah, this is me. How much do I owe?

(Owner)

Nine grand, all in all.

(Unique)

I'll need the keys to the car.

< The owner looks skeptically at him. Then he hands him the keys.>

< Unique opens the trunk, and unzips a gym bag stacked with money.>

< He removes ten stacks and hands them to the man.>

(Unique)

Your tip is included.

[_ _

[...]

98. INT. (Unique's car – Night)

< Unique stops his car in front of Dee-dee's building. He is bobbing his head to EPMD's hit "I shot the sheriff.">

< He has on a leather outfit that matches the car's interior.>

[...]

[...]

< She heads towards the car with Damond in tow. She sits in the passenger seat, and closes the door. Damond stops outside her door.>

(Damond)

Damn, baby. You bounced on me to be with a nigga driving a fucking Mitsubishi? This shit is played out and wack as a fuck. What type of broke ass nigga you got up in there pushing some bullshit like this? It's not even a BMW.

< He turns to the small crowd that has assembled nearby. They are laughing too.>

(Dee-dee)

Fuck you Damond! You ain't ever had a car since I knew your silly broke ass. So, go get one and then run your raggedy mouth. Come on, baby let's go. Don't pay this fool no mind, cause he ain't shit.

< She gives Damond the middle finger as they pull off.>

99. EXT. (Rosetta's house – Next morning)

< Unique is standing on the porch with a gym bag on his shoulder. His sister is standing in front of him with her robe on. >

< He hands her his keys and points to his car. There is a cab waiting on the opposite side of the car. She happily kisses him on the cheek.>

100. INT. (Unique's new black BMW – Evening)

< As he drives down Dee-dee's block, he can see heads turning to appreciate a second look at his car.>

< He honks the horn twice as he stops in front of her building. He sees the same crowd that was there the day before. They are all gawking at his ride.>

< Damond is in the crowd as wide-eyed as the others, not knowing who is in the car.>

< Dee-dee walks past the crowd to go to the car. She spots Damond who is visibly shocked.>

(Dee-dee)

Hey Damond! Is this the new BMW you were talking about yesterday? I guess you opened your mouth a little too quickly, huh? Ha-ha-ha!

< The crowd snickers at Damond, as Dee-dee gets into the car.>

(Unique)

Yo,
homeboy!

(Damond)

What's up
dawg?

(Unique)

Check this out, and take it how you want to.

[...]

[...]

If you hustled half as hard as you run your mouth, maybe you would be rolling like this.

<Unique pats the hood of his car as he smiles proudly.>

101. INT. (Unique's apartment – Abandoned building – Night)

[...]

[...]

< Unique opens the door and Tony strolls into the elegantly furnished abode. Tony looks saddened.>

(Unique)
What's up,
homie?

(Tony)
Alright, alright. I just stopped through to see how everything is coming along.
I see you got shit running smooth as usual.

(Unique)
Everything is fly, son. No
doubt.

(Tony)
Yo, come see me later with whatever money you got from those hundred keys I gave
you.

(Unique)
What's up Tony? Everything is tight, ain't it?

(Tony)
Yea
h.
<Tony starts rubbing his temple, and looks
withdrawn.>

(Tony)
I just got to finish off the three hundred keys I got up the hill.
Shit is hot up there so, everything is moving too slow.

(Unique)
Tell you what. Just chill here for a minute. I'll be back through in
about an hour. Just sit tight and make yourself at home. Lock
the door behind me, ah-ight?

102. INT. (Unknown nightclub – Office)
< Unique is standing on the other side of the owner's desk. He is removing stacks of
kilos from a box on the floor in front of him.>
< He is placing them on the desk beside a stack of fifteen other kilos. The owner is
seated behind the desk, smoking a cigar and watching him. Unique stacks the last
kilo on top of the desk.>
< There are now twenty kilos on the desk. The owner blows smoke into the air, and
pulls a briefcase up from under his desk.>
< He opens it revealing multiple rolls of money. They shake hands.>

[...]

[...]

103. EXT. (Brooklyn bridge)

< Unique stands in between his van and a red convertible Jaguar, with two twelve year old hustlers.>

< He hands them one of the cardboard boxes. Then one of the boys leans over and retrieves an expensive suitcase. He spins the combination and opens it. It is stocked with rolls of money. He removes the stacks and places them on the trunk of his car. Then he stuffs the suitcase with the kilos.>

104. INT. (Unique's van)

< He drives into a "Giant food" parking lot. A jeep Cherokee comes forward flashing its headlights.>

[...]

[...]

< Both trucks stop as the drivers windows are inches away. The dark tinted windows of the Cherokee rolls down to reveal a fly girl. >

< Unique hands her a box through the window. She hands him a “Giant food” shopping bag.>

< Her window rolls up as she pulls off.>

105. EXT. (The projects – Apartment building)

<Unique is walking away from his van carrying one of his cardboard boxes. He is strolling toward the building’s glass door.>

< An older, full figured woman opens the door. She has a white poodle beside her leg and a book bag dangling from her hand.>

< She looks behind her and gestures with her head for somebody to come to her.>

< A tall, menacing looking man steps up to her side. She directs Unique to the man.>

< He hands the man the box and kisses the woman on her cheek. She hands him the book bag and nods her head.>

106. INT. (Unknown building’s hallway)

< Unique is standing among five males. He has one of his cardboard boxes between his legs.>

< He hands each man four kilos, and they each hand him a different bag full of money.>

< He sits the bags before him and pulls out a hefty trash bag.>

107. INT. (Unique’s apartment)

< Tony pulls the door open. Unique walks in and plops down on the couch exhausted.>

< He holds a key ring with a single key on it, in the air for Tony to see.>

(Unique)

This is what I want you to do. Take the van up the hill, because I just moved what I had to, and your seven hundred grand is in the van. I’ll keep the Benz down here until you get back since it’s still parked where you left it.

(Tony)

You telling me you just pushed a hundred keys in an hour and fifteen minutes?

(Unique)

Yeah. Niggas was sick because I didn’t have enough to cover what everybody wanted.

(Tony)

Straight
up?

(Unique)

Word is
bond.

(Tony)

Since you’re moving shit so fast, why don’t you take the three hundred I got up the hill, and move them down here so I can pay these fucking people. This slow shit up

[...]

[...]

the hill is got them worried. I don't want them to lose faith in our moves.

(Unique)

[...]

[_ .

That's all good. Take the van and move your loot out, then fill it up with as many keys as it will fit, then bring it back. I'll make a few calls while you're out to let niggas know I re-upped.

(Tony)

Cool. I'll be back in a few then.

108. EXT. (Unique's apartment – Early morning)

< Tony and a younger companion are on the steps, as Unique parks behind another van in front of the building.>

< He gets out the van, stretches and yawns, then tosses Tony the keys to the van.>

< Tony catches them with both hands. He and his companion also look tired.>

(Tony)

What's wrong
homie?

< Unique goes to the Van's side door and opens it. He grabs a tightly stuffed gym bag and straps it over his shoulder.>

< The vans back area is filled with cardboard boxes. He slams the door shut.>

(Unique)

Nothing.

(Tony)

When you called and told us to meet you out front, I thought you had a problem.

(Unique)

Nah. I didn't want almost three million dollars sitting in this van, waiting to be stolen.
Not after all my hard work.

(Tony)

Man don't bullshit me. You can't be finished.

< Unique smiles and pats the stuffed bag on his shoulder.>

(Unique)

My cut's in the bags. Those boxes in the back now holds your cut.
Be careful, bro. I saw the cops pulling over some niggas a few blocks from here.

< Tony smiles and they shake hands.>

(Tony)

You
bet.

109. INT. (Ronn timer's house – Living room – Afternoon)

< Unique pauses and stares with a look of surprise at Kenny.>

[_ .

[...]

< Kenny stands up from the couch grinning.>

< Ronette walks up and glances proudly at both men as they embrace.>

[...]

[...]

(Unique)

What's going on with you? I saw the company truck outside.
How's everything going on with business?

< A look of sadness overcomes Kenny as he drops his head.>

(Kenny)

Well, all is okay, I guess. It's not really paying well, but business is going perfectly other than that.

(Unique)

Oh, I see what it is. Don't sweat it bro, I got a little something to help you out.
Come ride with me. I got a trip to take. But first, I want to get right.

(Kenny)

Alright. Let's
go.

110. INT. (High fashion men's store – Mall)

< Kenny is standing in front of the checkout counter. He is dishing out several hundred dollar bills to the sales clerk. They both smile. He grabs his four bags off the counter and turns toward Unique.>

< Unique has six shopping bags clinched in his fist as he grins at Kenny.

111. INT. (Unique's BMW)

< Unique is maneuvering his way through traffic. Kenny is in the passenger seat.>

(Kenny)

Yeah, dad ain't paying and I'm running the company. That's why I took a second job as a janitor, so I can save some money so Pat and I can move away. I'm tired, little bro.

(Unique)

Yo, check this out. The money I just gave you, I want you to go scoop up your girl and bounce to wherever you're trying to go. It ain't nothing but fifteen grand, but it's more than enough to get y'all started. Plus, I'll be hitting you off on the regular as long as you need it. Now, you see why I never liked the fucking bum. He ain't no father of mine. That shit is for real!

112. EXT. (Tony's projects – Evening)

< Unique is standing in between the driver's door of his BMW.>

< He is facing Tony, who is standing on the opposite side of the driver's door.>

(Tony)

Yo, I'mma be gone to the Dominicans for about a week.
So, just grab yourself a breather and when I breeze back, we just hit 'em hard.

<They fist bump.>

[...]

[...]

(Unique)

I'm feeling that. Hit me when you touch back. I'm out Homie.

[...]

[...]

<They shake hands.>
<Unique gets in his car and shuts the door.>
< Tony steps back as he drives off.>

113. INT. (Unique's BMW)

< He turns up a ghetto block. As he nears the corner, he spots old Derrick sitting on the hood of a new MercedesBenz.>
< There are two dudes standing in front of him, talking to him.>
< Unique looks through his rear view mirror at the men. He hits his left blinker and turns the corner.>

114. EXT. (Derrick's project

< Derrick is seated on the hood of a new Mercedes.>
< He's speaking with the two men Unique glimpsed when going by.>
< Unique walks from behind the car toward the driver's side.>
< He snatches two nine millimeter pistols from his waistline.>
< He jabs one barrel against the side of Derrick's temple.>
< The other men are the recipients of the second nine's assault.>
< He now stares into Derrick's petrified eyes.>

(Unique)

Remember me,
muthafucka?

You think I forgot about you runnin' up in my spot? Huh?

(Derrick)

Yo, man... I was fucked up back then off coke. I always had respect for your
hustle, Mike!

I mean that shit! I was just fucked up. Don't kill me Mike. I'm...I'm on some
different shit now.

I'm getting money, man, I'll break you off, homie. Just let me live...please.

(Unique)

You know the rules nigga...you know.

< He fires two shots point blank into the man's body.>
< Blood spurts out the other side of his body, as he crumbles sideways to the
pavement.>

115. INT. (Airplane – Miami – Night)

< Unique is asleep in his seat.>

(Captain V.O.)

Please fasten your seatbelts. We will be landing in Miami in fifteen
minutes.

116. INT. (Unique's mother 's house)

[...]

[...]

- < A cab pulls to the curb in front of a small one story flat house.>
- < Unique looks out the back passenger window at the little house that appears to be glowing from the soft illumination within.>
- < Unique exits the cab carrying an expensive suitcase.>
- < He steps up to the door, and knocks.>

[...]

[...]

< A short, thin woman opens the door. She nods hello.>

(Maria)

My name is Maria. Come on in, Unique.

I'm more than sure, your mother will be pleasantly surprised to see you.

117. INT. (His mother's living room)

< Unique is carrying the suitcase, as he follows Maria into the room.>

< He looks down at her, smiling warmly, as she returns in kind before heading to a back area.>

(Unique)

Thank
you.

< Trina sprints happily into the room, and throws her arms around his neck.>

< He laughs as she kisses him all over his face.>

(Trina)

My
baby!

(Unique)

Come on, ma. Don't start that mushy shit.

<She squeezes him harder, as he kisses her cheek.>

< She lays her head against his shoulder. She pulls herself away, then palms his face, kissing him sweetly upon the forehead.>

< She then holds his hands, as he glances around the living room.>

(Unique)

Damn, ma. You could've told me that you were crammed up in this little place.

< She guides him to the sofa.>

(Trina)

Boy, you know me. As long as my house is clean, and I got a roof over my head, I'm fine.

< She curls her legs beneath her body, as he sits down beside her.>

< She smears down his eyebrows.>

(Unique)

I know that ma, but I want the best for my mother.

(Trina)

Yes, I know baby, but this is all your mother can

[...]

[...]

afford. (Unique)

[...]

[...

I'll take care of all this here, because I ain't going for my mother living in no house so small you can barely fit a deck of cards in it. Don't worry ma, I got this.

< She playfully smacks his across his shoulder.>

(Trina)

Boy, stop talking about my little house, and go wash up.
The bathroom is over there.

(Unique)

Shit, this place is so damn small, I can feel the grass growing beneath my feet.

< He leaps up, as she playfully tries to grab him.>

118. INT. (Trina's living room)

< Trina is seated on the couch, with her cotton pajamas on.>

< Unique is sitting alongside in silk pajamas.>

< There is a pillow and a folded quilt on his lap.>

(Unique)

Yo, ma...if you won the lottery what type of crib would you want?
What type of furniture would you put in it?

< She runs her index finger beneath her chin, as she ponders the question.>

< She raises up and walks briskly into the back area.>

< She returns, flipping through the pages of a magazine she is carrying.>

< She sits down and hands him one.>

< She finds the page she was searching for, and hands him the magazine.>

< Unique is looking at the first magazine. It is an updated issue of a weekly Miami real estate magazine.>

< The second is actually a catalog from one of Miami's prestigious furniture companies.>

< He notices that the circles of red ink around what she liked best in both books.>

(Unique)

These books are nice. Can I keep them, so I can look through them tonight?

(Trina)

You can have them. They're all the things I've dreamed of.
Never mind that right now. You're mine tonight, and we have a lot to talk about.

< He starts grinning.>

119. INT. (Trina's dream house – Early morning)

< Unique is standing near the large backyard pool, holding a briefcase against his leg.>

< He is speaking with the owner of the home. A white man in his mid-forties, with a

[...

[...]

nice disposition.> (Unique)

[...]

[. . .

So, how much are you asking for this place?

(Home owner)

We're asking, two hundred and twenty thousand to be paid over thirty years, on a set mortgage plan.

(Unique)

Would you take one hundred and fifty thousand in cash?

(Home owner)

We most certainly will.

(Unique)

Okay, this briefcase is yours. Half the money is in there.

< The owner looks hesitantly at Unique, then grimaces and picks up the briefcase. He opens it.>

(Home owner)

Wow, this is really beautiful.

< He closes the briefcase and extends his open hand. Unique shakes it>

(Home owner)

Well, Unique, we can have the rest of the payment arranged for next week.

I'll have my attorney contact yours, and everything will be finalized.

As of now, the place is yours.

(Unique)

Thanks. I'll be moving in tonight if it's no problem.

(Home owner)

Fine, it's all yours. You can move in anytime you wish.

I'll be leaving now. You have my phone number and my attorney's, and I have yours.

Here's your receipt. It's really been nice doing business with you.

120. INT (Trina's house – Living room – Evening)

< Unique is stretched out on the couch. He is fully dressed, and has a small gift wrapped box with a red bow resting on his stomach.>

< His eyes are closed, but open as he jumps up at the sound of an old car's engine.>

< He dashes over to the door with the box in his hand, and peeps out the door curtain to see his mother walking towards the house. She has her work uniform on.>

< As she raises her key to unlock the door, he pulls it open at just the right moment.>

< She is startled.>

[. . .

[...]

(Unique)

Get a good look at this mouse hole,
mommy. This is the last time you're
going to see it.

[...]

[...]

(Trina)

What? Baby, what are you talking about?
And whose car is that parked in front of the house?
Do you know?

< She points to a Chrysler LeBaron convertible that is parked in front of her old Buick.

(Unique)

Oh, that's just a rental car that I got a little while ago.

< He presents the little box to her.

< She smiles as she accepts it.

(Trina)

What's
this?

(Unique)

Go ahead, open it.

< She rips the top off. The first thing she sees is a cutout of the home she had circled in the magazine.>

< She looks up to him with confusion.>

< He gestures excitedly for her to continue.>

< She takes the cutout from the box and her eyes begin to water.>

< She sees two sets of keys in the bottom of the box.>

(Unique)

Wait until you see it. It's so much bigger than what it looks like on paper.

(Trina)

Baby, I won't believe it till I see it.

(Unique)

Momma, you just said the magic words.
Let's go! It's close by, so you can follow me
to your new place. Don't bring anything
except your beautiful, fine self.

121. EXT. (Trina's new home)

< Trina drives her car up the driveway, and parks behind Unique.>

< He gets out the car, and points happily towards the house.>

< She leaps out of the car. Tears of joy fall as she runs to her new home.>

< She makes her own breeze as she rushes by him.>

< She fumbles with the keys and locks, and then bursts into the house with youthful enthusiasm.>

[...]

[...]

122. INT. (Trina's new house – Living room)
< Unique steps into the open doorway, smiling ear to ear.>

[...]

[. . .

< His smile fades when he sees her on her knees, covering her face with her hands, and her face pressed against the carpet.>

< The spacious living room includes all the furniture circled in the catalog.>

< He drops to his knees beside her, and gently pulls her upright.>

< Her body heaves from emotion.>

(Unique)
What's wrong,
ma?

(Trina)

Baby I am just so happy. All I ever wanted was my babies back, and look, what you my youngest child has done for me. Baby I love you so much, and it has nothing to do with this house.

But I do love this house, baby.

< They hug.>

< Tears roll down his face.>

(Unique)
Mommy, you deserve this. You deserve everything your heart desires.
Anything you need in this world, if I can make it happen, I will.

123. EXT. (Street intersection)

< Unique stops at the red light. A jeep wrangler pulls up next to him. The stereo is blasting a bass filled "Luke Skywalker" song. The jeep is filled with four fine looking women. The woman who is driving catches Unique's glance in their direction, and reaches to turn down the music.>

(Shantel)
Southern accent: Hey, baby...what's
up?

(Unique)
Nothing
much.

(Shantel)
You're not going to the block party over in the projects?

(Unique)
You inviting
me?

< The light turns green, and she gestures him to pull over into the supermarket parking lot.>

< He follows.>

[. . .

[...]

< He pulls up beside the jeep. She has a fabulous body and is rocking with all the attributes.>

< He gets out the car, as all the girls check him out.>

(Shantel)
What's your
name?

[...]

[_ _

(Unique)
Unique.

(Shantel)
Unique, huh? Well Unique, you must not be from
around here. My name is Shantel, and these rowdy
girls here are my sisters.
That's Mercedes, Porsche, and Lexus.

(Unique)
Those are some pretty nice and um... expensive names.

< The women all laugh.

(Shantel)
So, where you from?

(Unique)
) New
York.

(Shantel)
Wow, that's cool. Well, we got a block party jumping off in
the projects And yeah, I'm inviting you, Mr.
Unique.
All you got to do is follow the jeep.

(Unique)
Cool with
me.

124. EXT. (Projects)

< Luke Skywalker's hit "Me so horny" is pumping through the mountainous concert
style speakers.>

< Unique is walking behind his four shapely hostesses. He observes the southern
flavor as they walk around the field next to a basketball court. The court is next to a
two story, run down house. The area is crowded with expensive cars, with blacks and
Latino's dancing around.>

< Some women are dancing exotically in their booty shorts, while some men try to keep
up. Others are standing around, drinks and beers in hand, enjoying the atmosphere.>

< Unique and his companions stop near the DJ section. He looks over his shoulder and
sees his car, the girl's jeep, and many other vehicles.>

< The girls are hugging numerous people they know.>

< One male struggles with the chain around his pitbull's neck, causing a few people to
leap on top of some of the parked cars.>

< The man's smile reveals a grill full of gold teeth.>

[_ _

[_ .

(Unique)

Shantel, what type of shorts are those?

< He is pointing at a thick female who is lost in a zone, shaking her plump and ample assets to a hard, bass driven rhythm.

[_ .

[_ _

(Shantel)

We call those, "Daisy Dukes!"
You telling me, they don't wear those up in New York?

(Unique)

Nah. I wish the hell they did!
What's that dance she's doing? Damn!!

(Shantel)

That's the "Doodoo Brown!"

< He points to another brick house female.>

(Unique)

What about
her?

(Shantel)

That's called the "Pop that
coochie." You like it?

(Unique)

Hell yeah. But, up my way, if their man peeped them carrying on like that, they'd get
their asses whipped.

< They all laughed.>

< Unique starts mimicking the girl's provocative dances, causing more laughter.>

(Unique)

Yo...that's just crazy! And look at those asses!
The thickest girls I know back home, don't even have half the ass of the smallest
babe out this bitch.

(Mercedes)

Yeah, and don't you forget that shit, homeboy!

< Shantel and her sisters start dancing freaky in front of him.>

(Unique)

Damn. Every nigga I see got a mouth full of gold teeth

(Lexus)

That's the way we play it down here.

< She grins, and displays her own gold
teeth.>

(Lexus)

I'm getting two more on the bottom.

< She pulls out a joint from her bra, light's it up and tries to

[_ _

[...]

hand it to him.>

(Lexus)

[...]

[_ .

You smoke?

(Unique)

Yeah, but not that cute little shit right there.

< He pulls out a zip lock bag filled with Mary Jane, greener and more aromatic than anything they had ever seen.>

< He rolls a fat spliff equal in proportion to the lipstick cylinder from which Porsche is applying to her thick, sensuous lips.>

< Handing the spliff to Chantel, he casually awaits the forthcoming comments.>

< She lights up, takes a puff, and immediately starts coughing.>

< By the time she stops and looks up, her eyes are bloodshot red.>

(Shantel)

Damn! What the fuck is this, "Crypto?"

(Unique)

I don't know 'bout no "Crypto," but that's some skunk right there baby.

< Lexus gently slaps Shantel's arm and demands the spliff from her.>

(Lexus)

Damn, dawg! Pass that shit already before you choke half to death out here.

< Lexus's reaction is similar to his when she takes a puff.>

< Gunshots ring out.>

< Unique grabs the four girls and shove them behind a stack of speakers.>

< He snatches free his new pistol with the infrared beam switch on the side and spits off three gunshots into the sky. The other gunshots fade off into the distance as quickly as they came.>

< He leads them over to their vehicles.>

(Unique)

Y'all

alright?

<They all nod their heads that they are okay.>

(Unique)

Well, ladies, I had a nice time while it lasted.

< He starts writing his name down on a piece of paper, while Shantel does the same.>

(Shantel)

We did too Unique. We'll kick it again some more another time

(Unique)

That's cool with

[_ .

[..

me.

[..

[_ _

125. Ext. (Club Rollexx – Night)

< The parking lot is filled with expensive cars.>

< Men and half-naked women are leaving and entering the club.>

< Unique parks his car next to a convertible Roll Royce.>

< He walks up to the entrance doors, holds up a fifty dollar bill before the gigantic bouncer's eyes, and nods down to his own waist.>

< The bouncer scans Unique's body with his eyes, nods his approval, and takes the money.>

< Unique strolls into the club.>

126. Int. (Club Rollexx)

< Unique gets comfortable in a booth at the back of the club. He scans the crowded venue. He sees several sexy strippers dancing on the poles and with each other on the flat wide stage. There are a lot of drunk pussy hungry hustlers around the edge of the stage, putting dollar bills into the thong straps of their favorite strippers. Everyone seems to be having a good time.>

< He notices the exchange of large amounts of money. Hustlers are at tables giving waitresses hundreds of dollars for their hustlers, and money hungry broads posted up at the huge bar area sucking up liquor shot after shot, buying the most expensive liquor in the club.

< He signals a waitress over to his table. She smiles seductively at him. He smiles back.>

(Unique)

Let me get a bottle of Dom Perignon, a six pack of Heineken, and a plate of
barbecued Buffalo wings.

< She quickly jots his order down on her pad and he hands her three one
hundred dollar bills.>

(Unique)

Keep the
change.

(Sparkle)

Damn, thank
you.

(Unique)

It's nothing. What's your name girl?

< She extends her hand. He accepts it, holding her hand for a moment before letting
go.>

(Sparkle)

Can I get you anything else?

(Unique)

Well, now that you've asked, you can round up about eight of the sexiest bitches in
here and tell them to come get some of this money.

[_ _

[. __

< He pulls out a big knot of bills and lays them out on the table in front of him.>

(Sparkle)

What kind of girls are you looking for?

< She tries not to
laugh.>

[. __

[_ _

(Unique)

Shit, it don't really matter. Just get me the finest bitches you come across.
You're fine yourself, so I trust your judgment.

< He hands her another twenty and she smiles.>

(Sparkle)

No problem at all sweetheart.

< She hurries off.>

< He pulls out a spliff, lights it up, leans back in his chair and puffs it.>

< He starts looking up into the sky and begins to daydream.>

< Sparkle breaks his frame of thought. She has everything he ordered. "Everything."

(Sparkle)

So, how you like 'em?

< She starts putting his beverages and his plate of food before him.>

(Unique)

Well, shit, I haven't tasted any of it yet.

(Sparkle)

I'm not talking about that, I'm talking about these.

< She moves from his view, so that he can see eight light skinned, gorgeous, scantily clad women.>

(Unique)

Oh, well damn! It's all good, it's all good. They'll do for now.

< He hands each girl a fifty dollar bill.>

(Unique)

Now, I want y'all to strip and dance for me.

< They all comply except Sparkle.>

(Unique)

Now, Sparkle go get me some chocolate bitches in all shapes and sizes.
Damn, can a nigga spend his money up in here, or what?

(Sparkle)

No
problem

< She starts laughing as she scurries off.>

< She comes back with six dark skinned girls and begins dancing up a storm to a hit song entitled, "Bitch betta have my money," by AMG, from California.

[_ _

[...]

< He starts slapping the ass of a chocolate female who is giving him a very sexual lap dance.

[...]

[...]

<He takes a sip from his bottle of Don P.

< Other dancers and hustlers ease their way over to his table. The owner also eases his way over to Unique's table. He places two bottles of Crystal on the table and pours two drinks. One of the women move aside to allow him to sit next to Unique.

127. INT. (Club Rollexx)

< The club has settled down some. Unique and the owner, Stone, are seated alone at Unique's table. Bottles of champagne are scattered around the table.

< Stone hands Unique his business card. It reads, "Catering to your needs in Miami. 555. 1300."

< He puts the card in his pocket.

(Stone)

Let me know if your peeps need anything while you're down here.
My peeps got all the best of everything.

(Unique)

I don't need nothing from Miami, but what I am interested in is the strip club scene. I want to know the ins and outs to this shit, and how to make a profit. I wouldn't mind popping one of these up in New York City. Harlem would go wild with a spot like this uptown.

(Stone)

Well, we got a lot to talk about.

< Unique signals Sparkle over to them. He counts out twelve one hundred dollar bills.>

(Unique)

That's for the liquor I wanted to drink, but couldn't. And this is for you.

< He hands her a hundred dollar bill.

(Sparkle)

Thank you, Unique. Stone, I'm going home, okay?

< She locks eyes with Unique, not paying Stone any attention.>

(Stone)

e)

Okay

< Unique waves goodbye to her. Stone looks up at her.>

(Stone)

[...]

[...]

Bye,
Sparkle.

< She smiles and walks off.>

(Unique)

[...]

[...]

You see, Stone, I ain't got no problems at all paying for my game. I know the game is to be sold. Now, Stone, my man, I bought out your whole bar and tipped every hoe in here. I think that should cover me on a playa to playa conversation on this strip club shit. I'm a modest man Stone, so when you see me throwing around money like this, it's strictly because I can. Money is long and I look out for those who look out for me.

< Stone stands.>

(Stone)

Come on Unique, let's go up to my office.

128. INT. (Club COCO'S)

< This club lacks the classy looks that the Rollexx club was designed with, but it still served its title well as a strip club. There are plenty of good looking strippers shaking their asses to the delight and encouragement of the loud and wild men surrounding the stage like a pack of wolves.>

< The door leading to the stripper's dressing room is only a few feet from where Unique is seated, so he sees each girl coming and going. Some are exhausted from a hard night's work, others are high as kites and entering the room.

< Unique's attention is frozen on one particular stripper, Jade. She is barely five feet tall, and can't weigh any more than a hundred and ten pounds. Her skin is the tone of copper, as is her waist length curly hair. Her cheek bones are sharp to the extent where they combine perfectly with her naturally green eyes. Her curves sway elegantly as she walks past Unique's table with a sophisticated form of grace that seems out of place.>

(DJ V.O.)

This is the pleasure of the house! Gentlemen, feast your eyes on Ms. Jade!

< Her performance ends to the disapproval, but applause of the men gathered around the club. They watch her exit the stage and strut in the direction of the dressing room. As she nears Unique's table, he signals her to stop. She complies.>

(Unique)

You mind if I ask you something?

< She eyes him with skepticism.>

(Jade)

Excuse
me?

(Unique)

My name is Unique. I watched you perform just now and I'm curious about something.

[...]

[...]

< She seemed prepared for a degrading comment, but remained polite.>

(Jade)

[...]

[_ .

What's that?

(Unique)

Well, I want to ask you this. Have you ever done some wild, impulsive, spur of the moment shit that you never thought you would do, but did it just once and had no regrets?

(Jade)
Why?

(Unique)

Well, I was just curious, because I got my mind made up that I want your pussy bad enough to fly you up to New York with me, and show you a nice time up my way.

(Jade)

Nigga, I'm so tired of y'all so called ballers coming in here promising to take me away from here. You telling me there ain't no pussy in New York City?

(Unique)

Yeah, there's pussy in New York, but none of it comes in a package as fly as yours.

< She smiles, trying unsuccessfully not to blush.>

(Unique)
I'm
serious.

(Jade)

Well, mister big shot New Yorker, I'm going to hold you to your word. Just tell me when our flight leaves.

(Unique)
Seventhirty

(Jade)

Well, wait for me right here. I'll be back in fifteen minutes. If I come back and you're gone, I'll know you're full of shit like the rest of these niggas.

< He grins.>

129. EXT. (CO-CO'S)

< Unique and Jade, are strolling towards his car. She has on casual slacks and shoes. Her large Coach bag is slung over her shoulder. He stops at his driver's door. He looks over to her. She is walking beside his trunk.>

[_ .

[...]

(Unique)

Get your ass in bitch. (Playfully)

[...]

[...]

(Jade)

Fuck you, nigga. I got my own ride. (Playfully retorts)

< She walks across from his car to a Mitsubishi Montero.>

< She opens the driver's door and tosses her bag over to the passenger seat.>

(Jade)

I'll follow you.

130. INT (Trina's old house – Daybreak)

< Unique is signing his signature to a note he has written. He wraps a red bow around it.>

< He sits on the coffee table. He looks over to Jade who is standing in the open doorway.>

(Unique)

Come on
in.

Naw, nigga. This ain't New

York City. (Unique)

Damn, bitch. We got two hours to kill before our flight leaves, so stop tripping.

(Jade)

No, fuck that. We can go to my crib and freshen up so I can pick
up a few things I can't believe I'm actually doing this shit.

(Unique)

No, you go and meet me back here.

(Jade)

Aww, nigga I knew you weren't no different than the rest of these basers out here.

You just want some pussy so you can ditch me off somewhere.

131. INT. (Jade's apartment)

< The door opens. Unique briskly walks past Jade who has not even taken the key out the door.>

< He has his gun in his hand. He scans the area, peeps in, closes the door, then returns to the living room and tucks his weapon into his waistline.>

(Unique)

I know you understand.

< She nods in agreement.>

(Jade)

That's a damn shame.

[...]

[...]

(Unique)
What you
mean?

[...]

[...]

(Jade)

You've got to find that out on your own, Unique, because if you don't know it already, it's not my job to tell you.

< She takes his hand and leads him into her bedroom.>

< He sits down on the bed while she turns on her small stereo system.>

< Anita Baker's sweet voice fills the room. She starts grabbing shower paraphernalia.>

(Jade)

That's my girl right there. I wake up every morning, smoke a spliff, drink some herbal tea, and let Anita Baker get my day started.

(Unique)

That's
interesting.

(Jade)

Make yourself at home, or you can join me in the tub.

< He pulls his shirt off as he follows her.>

132. INT. (Jade's apartment – Bathroom)

< Unique is asleep in the bubble bath.>

< Jade rises up from the opposite end of the tub, as the suds glide down her naked body.>

133. EXT. (J.F.K. airport, N.Y.C. – The next morning)

< Unique holds the exit door open for Jade. They walk in the midst of people coming and leaving the airport.>

< He holds her hand as he scans the signs being held up by several limousine drivers. He spots the driver holding up a sign that reads "Mr. and Mrs. Black." He points to the driver.

(Unique)

There's our ride right there.

< She focuses on the sign and begins to blush. They approach the driver.>

(Unique)

Take us to the Marriott, my man.

134. INT. (Marriott hotel – Penthouse suite)

< The entrance door opens to the luxurious room.>

< Unique surprises Jade by scooping her up in his arms and carrying her over the threshold, then over to the bed.>

< He lies her across it then stumbles on top of her. Their eyes lock.>

[...]

[...]

(Unique)

This is New York City.

[...]

[...]

< They kiss passionately. He finally peels himself off of her and goes into the bathroom. He returns.>

(Unique)
I just cut the Jacuzzi on. Can you swim?

< She giggles.>

(Jade)
Like a butt naked whale.

< They both giggle. He softly gives her a peck across her lips.>
< They gaze into each other's eyes.>

(Unique)
Will you join
me?

< She nods her approval and begins to unbutton her blouse, never looking away from his eyes.>

135. INT. (Marriott hotel – Bathroom)
< Unique and Jade, are reclining in the bubbling Jacuzzi.>
< A bottle of Crystal rests on the railing beside Unique's wine glass.>
< He is taking a puff from his spliff while Jade sips from her glass.>
< He hands her the spliff. She places her glass on the rail and then takes two puffs.>

(Unique)
So, both your parents are lawyers?

< She nods her head in agreement, then she passes the spliff back, and slides down into the water leaving only her head visible.>

(Unique)
So, tell me how you ended up in Coco's.

< She exhales a deep breath, then sits up slightly. The top of her cleavage is visible.>
< She looks sadly at the bubbles in front of her.>

(Jade)
My girlfriend, China, is a stripper and she's originally from Miami, that's how I ended up there. We met in my hometown, Baltimore, where we attended Baltimore school of performing arts. After my parents cut me off financially, I was really struggling. They wanted me to become what they are but I wanted to be an actress. So, China suggested I try stripping last summer. I was against it, but I needed the

[...]

[_ .

money and she said I could try it in Miami. All I wanted was to continue to pay my way through school.

[_ .

[. _ _]

< She starts crying. He puts the spliff down, and slides around to her.>
< He wipes her eyes.>

(Unique)
That's
okay.

(Jade)

No, I want you to know...I hate stripping. I feel violated every time I take the stage to perform. I wasn't into drugs but weed helps me to deal with my job. This is all I know how to do. I gave up school to strip fulltime so that I can become financially independent. I'm not a whore, I'm nineteen and I'm broke.

< He pulls her into his embrace as she cries.>

136. INT (Marriott hotel – Sleep area that night)

< Jade awakens in bed alone. She scans the area then gets out of bed. She has on her bra and panties.

< She briskly walks over to the bathroom. She comes out smiling upon seeing a red rose on the bed along with a note.>

< It reads:

(Unique V.O.)

I'm sorry I had to leave, but there is something I'm going through mentally that I can't explain because I don't know what it is. But, I do know that it's because of you. Please, don't be upset with me. I'm running because of the life I lead, not because of yours.

Jade, even though I have never made love to you physically, mentally, I have held and caressed your desires a thousand times. I understand and feel the pains of your life, and I want to attempt to soothe your hurt as much as I can. With that in mind, I have left you a gift.

< Tears begin to splatter the page.>

Conquer your hopes and dreams. Look down into the bottom drawer next to the bed and use what you see to make something better for yourself, and forget you ever met me. (The letter ends)

< She goes and opens the drawer next to the bed.>

< Her jaw drops and her eyes widen in stock.>

< The drawer is filled with stacks of money.>

< There is a note on top of the money that reads: "A hundred grand. Take care.">

(Jade)
I can't believe this shit!

137. INT. (Unique's apartment)

[. _ _]

[. _ _

- < Stevie Wonder's "These three words," is blasting throughout the apartment.>
- < Unique is seated slumped on the couch with his head cocked back, and his legs stretched out and open.
- < He stares blankly at the ceiling. He doesn't blink.>
- < He looks sadly to his right and exhales a deep depressing breath.>

[. _ _

[_ .

< Then he bursts into laughter and pushes himself upright.>

(Unique)
Damn, I'm on some different shit.

138. INT. (Tony's apartment)

< There are several cardboard boxes on the floor by the table.>
< Two Spanish men carry two boxes a piece out of the house.>
< Tony is putting the last kilo on the table into the box.>
< Unique is leaning against the far wall with his hands in his pockets and legs crossed. He is pouting.>
< Tony goes over and gently squeezes his partner's shoulder.>

(Tony)
Yo, what's the matter my friend?

(Unique)
Nada.

(Tony)
You
cool?

(Unique)
Yeah, I'm
cool.

(Tony)
Don't worry, I'll bring the vans down to the parking garage by your spot myself later. Here is an extra set of keys to the vans I'll be bringing. Go on down now and get your head right. I'll drop the two vans off by two in the morning.

< They exchange brief hugs. Tony looks concerned as he watches Unique head for the exit.>

139. INT. (Unique's apartment – Day)
< Sade's hit song, "Cherish the day," is playing.>
< Unique is standing and staring out of the window.>
< He begins to daydream.>

(Unique's daydream)

140. INT. (Marriott hotel – Bathroom – Late evening)
< Unique and Jade, are seated beside each other in the Jacuzzi. He is sipping a glass of wine.>
< Her halffilled glass is beside the halffilled bottle of Crystal.>

(Jade)
Do you know anything about desire?

[_ .

[...]

(Unique)
What do you
mean?

[...]

[...]

(Jade)

I'm talking about desire. Your need to do something or to want something. It's just something you feel. Like when you're hungry, you have a desire to eat. You see?

(Unique)

Yeah, I understand what you're saying.

(Jade)

Well, can I ask you something personal?

(Unique)

Yeah, you can ask me anything.

< She climbs on top of his legs and stares deeply into his eyes.>

(Jade)

Okay. You hustle to survive, right?

(Unique) Mm.

hmm. (Impressed)

(Jade)

Well, does your desire to stay in the game outweigh your desire to leave the game alone?

< Unique snaps out of his daydream, and turns away from the window.>

(Unique)

e) No!

141. INT. (Tony's apartment)

< Unique is followed by one of Tony's soldiers as he walks over to Tony who is seated at the table eating pasta.>

< Unique drops a key ring with two keys on it in front of Tony, then goes straight to the refrigerator and retrieves a bottle of champagne.>

< He grabs two wine glasses from the cabinet, and goes to sit down at the table.>

< Tony watches him pour a drink and stares sadly at the glass.>

(Tony)

Yo, you've been out of it for a week now. What is it that's bothering you?

< Unique takes a sip from his glass, and stares at Tony with a look of recognition.>

(Unique)

Yo, I had a blast down in Miami. I played the strip clubs and those bitches down there are definitely fly. They had no problem getting butt ass naked and shaking those big fine asses, yo. It was unbelievable. Miami is a definite hotspot.

And yo, I met this old cat named, Stone. He hipped me to the whole game of making this club shit happen, and I'm feeling that whole set-up.

[...]

[__

(Tony)

Yo, if you had a good time like that, why the hell are you stressing? Shit, just take some more time off from things and go enjoy yourself.

(Unique)

I'm thinking about opening up one of those spots in Harlem. It'll be phat. It'll be laid out, I mean the works. I'll have nigga's heads spinning because the spot will be a combination of disco and strip club, with the baddest bitches on the planet. Yo, when my shit opens the rest of New York will be shutdown, unwillingly! And anything goes, you feel me? I want to bring a load of strippers from all over the south to set this shit off.

(Tony)

Yeah, I say go for it. Maybe that will stop you from tripping. You know all the ballers in the city, and the way you sell those kilos, you won't have any problem filling up a club in Harlem. So, like I said, take some time off and make it happen. As a matter of fact, I have a friend who's about to move back to the Dominican Republic and wants to see his Disco-tech club in Harlem. It holds two thousand.

(Unique)

Yo, I got to look into that. Wait till you see the 'Doo-doo brown' and the 'Pop that coochie' dance these southern females do. I'm going to open this up on some futuristic shit. By the time we're done, every bitch in New York City and all up and down the coast will want to be a stripper in "Club Millennium." That's what I'll call it, "Club Millennium."

142. EXT. (Club Disco-Tech – Late evening)

< Unique, Tony, and another Dominican male are standing in front of the entrance doors.>

< The men are standing in a small circle.>

< Unique nods his head in agreement to the unknown club owner and shakes his hand.>

< Unique looks over to the club and smiles proudly as Tony laughs and pats him on the shoulder.>

143. EXT. (Club Discotech – Late evening)

< Unique is putting two of his cardboard boxes on a large table. There are already four boxes on the table.>

< The eighteen year old drug dealers are standing on the opposite side of the table. Both of the youngsters place an expensive suitcase on the table. They open to reveal that they are stacked with rows of money.>

144. INT. (Tony's apartment – Night)

< Tony and Unique, are seated around the table watching two money machines count the currency that is in them.>

[__

[...]

< There are three mountainous stacks of money on the table and scattered around the floor are the cardboard boxes that they use to transport drugs and money.>

145. INT. (Music store – Day)

< Unique is sliding several bundles of money across the counter to the cashier.>

[...]

[...]

< Surrounding him are concert size speakers and other music equipment.>

146. EXT. (The New Club Millennium)

< The new club's electric sign is above the entrance doors. Signs are plastered all over the front of the building.>

< They read: Grand opening in one week. For more info listen to 98.7 Kiss, or call, 212-5555550.>

< Unique is standing near the open entrance doors.

< He is watching several men push trolleys.

< One with a Jacuzzi, another with a refrigerator, and one with black marble tables.

147. INT. (Tony's apartment)

< Tony shakes Unique's hand as he enters the apartment.>

< Occupying two whole walls are dark long sheets concealing large boxes.>

(Tony)

So, you like the townhouse?

(Unique)

Yeah, that joint's fly. It set me back half a mil, but it's definitely worth it.

Yo, what's up? Why you need me so urgently?

(Tony)

I got a present for you.

Come here...

(Unique

) Yo!

< They briefly embrace.>

(Tony)

Yo, this is simply the best to start your joint off on some real hot shit. And no doubt, the sky is too short of a limit to get in our business.

148. INT. (Club Millennium -Grand opening night)

< The club is packed to its full capacity with partygoers dressed in their finest wears. There is a multitude of races, accents, and cultures present. Everyone from street hustlers and drug kingpins to successful legal businessmen are there.>

< The hustlers are making their appearances to the company of the many sexy women present, while rich Jewish businessmen tag along at Unique's heels offering all sorts of business cards to him. He makes his way through the crowd.>

< Even though it is the most important night of Unique's club existence, he seems distant and gloomy.>

< A hand appears on his shoulder. He spins around to see a familiar face that he does not recognize.>

< The female's other hand goes around to Unique's stomach, where she feels his hand reaching for his gun. She leans close to his ear.>

[...]

[...]

(Stacey)

Well, I see nothing has changed with you, young man.

[...]

[_ .

< He finally recognizes her and gives her a hug.>

(Unique)

Oh, shit! Grab a seat. Damn, it's been a long time.

Where the hell have you been all these years? And why didn't you ever contact me?

(Stacey)

Well, I was looking for you. I went back to your old building looking for you, but your brother, Ron, chased me away and told me if I ever came back, he'd bust a cap in my ass. You know, how y'all nigga's be acting. But, we did all we could to get information on you, but we didn't get any help, so we just moved on with our lives.

(Unique)

I know all about what Ron did. But, who is this we you keep referring to?

(Stacey)

I'm talking about me and David. He used to drive you around and you never asked him his name. You always called him, "Yo, cab driver!" His name is David Miller, and my name isn't, "Hey, yo nurse!" It's Stacey, Stacey Miller.

(Unique)

So, y'all got married?

(Stacey)

Yeah. After you left we remained friends and everything just fell into place. We've been married for four years now, and we've got two beautiful bad ass boys. Donnie and Shaun.

< David strolls over carrying two drinks in his hands. He can see her face but not Unique's.>

< As he gets close enough to put down the drinks, one of them slips from the edge of the table and falls down to the floor, startling Unique.>

< Unique spins around as he whips out his firearm.>

< David just stands there shaking his head from side to side with a look of disbelief.>

< Stacey sips from the drink already in her hand and looks to Unique.>

(Stacey)

That's my husband. He was your cab driver. Now, Mike, if you don't mind, I'd appreciate it if you'd put that trouble maker back in your waistline. You're a very jumpy man. David, honey, I found him and he's still crazy as hell.

< Unique looks from David to Stacey, and back to David. He laughs and puts his gun away, shaking his head and smiling.>

< The two men hug then sit down at the table joining Stacey. David kisses his wife and looks to Unique.>

(Unique)

[_ .

[...]

Damn, man I didn't even recognize you behind all that facial hair and those extra pounds you put on. (David)

[...]

[_ _ _

Yeah, Mike, it's been years.

(Unique)
It's Unique now.

(David)
Come
again?

(Unique)
My name, is Unique now. I dropped Mike a few years ago.

(Stacey
) That's
nice.

< She takes a sip from her drink. Unique locks eyes with David. He takes a sip from his wife's glass.>

(Unique)
So, whatever became of the situation where your father was killed?

(David)
Well, Unique, the old man ain't around no more. He died just a few years ago. Somebody shot him six times and robbed his store. Of course, they checked his history and questioned me, but hey, I was home with my wife.

< He winks at Unique.>

(Stacey)
What about you Unique? What have you been up to?

(Unique)
Well, I just bought this club about a month ago.
I feel good about it, so I'm chilling now and having a nice time.

(David)
You mean you own this club?

(Unique)
Yeah, you like
it?

(David)
Shit, it's all we've been hearing about all week on television, the radio, and billboards.
Damn, I'm so proud of you. Now, who's the lucky lady?

[_ _ _

[...]

(Unique)

Oh, umm...she's

nobody.

(Stacey)

[...]

[_ _

I see that's another problem you still have. But, let me tell you something. One of these days you're going to have to trust somebody. So, your best bet is to make sure you're trusting the right kind of people, and turning your back on the wrong ones.

< He squirms in his seat.>

(Unique)

Jade. She's in Miami. She's not my woman or anything.
Look, you know my lifestyle, I can't get caught slipping. So, there is no lucky lady.

(Stacey)

Me and David saved your life all by ourselves, you know that right?

(Unique)

Yeah, I know
that.

(Stacey)

So, basically, you owe us.

(Unique)

I do owe y'all. Anything you need, just name it. I got enough money to cover it.

(Stacey)

Money ain't everything Unique. But, since you've got plenty, we want a million dollars. Ain't your health worth it? Or, you can find this girl Jade, and give yourself a break from all the bullshit you keep inside that makes you pull pistols out on your friends. You do that, and we're even.

< He grins and caresses his chin.>

(Unique)

I think I can do that for y'all.

(Stacey)

No, you're not doing it for us, you're doing it for yourself.
You never let anybody love you, and that's sad because you're lovable.

(DJ)

Yo, yo, yo! Unique, report to the stage!

< Unique looks at his watch.>

(Unique)

Oh shit, it's time for me to do my introduction.

< He makes his way to the stripper's stage.>

[_ _

[...]

< The DJ hands him a cordless mic as he passes the DJ booth.>

< He clicks on the mic as he steps to the stage and the music is turned off.>

< The crowd focuses on him.>

[...]

[. _ _

(Unique)

What's up everybody? How y'all feeling tonight? Y'all having a good time out there?

< The crowd claps and cheers.>

(Unique)

As long as y'all enjoy yourselves in my club, I'll enjoy myself. Everybody knows how it's going down in my spot. This is a respectable club and it's going to be run like one. That means no guns or knives. If a fistfight breaks out in here, my DJ won't even stop because, hell, ain't nothing wrong with a good old fashioned fist fight every now and then.

And ladies, if you want to bring your pretty asses out at night and act stuck up, I suggest you get your pretty little asses away from Club Millennium, because we don't sweat hoes here.

< Everybody begins to laugh.>

(Unique)

That means if somebody asks you to dance, and you act like you're too good, you will kindly be kicked out of my club. Now, before we get this party really jumping I'm going to introduce myself. My name is Unique, and I want to bring up a few people who helped me make this Club Millennium happen. When I call your name, come on up.

My partner, Tony... my brother, Kenny... Kim, Samone, Deedee, Kathy, Paul, Greg, Sparkle, Shantel,

Mercedes, Porsche, and Lexus. Also, my good friends, Stacey and David. And my main man, Stone who told me how to put this all together. And to my homeboy, Bobby...rest in peace.

Now, let's get this party jumping! I want all my stripper's on stage when my family and I walk off. Welcome to Club Millennium!

< The DJ plays a bass filled "Rump shaker" track as eighteen strippers come up on the stage and begin to peel off their formal party clothes, revealing scandalous bikini's. Some of the people looked surprised that some of the very people they spoke to and danced with earlier, are actually strippers for the club.

< The male and female dancers please the crowd with graphic, exotic scenes that border on pornography. After performing for a while, the strippers begin to file out into the audience.

(Male partygoer)

Damn! These hoes can't be from around here. Look at that shit they're doing!

< The female dancers are doing the Doo-doo brown and Pop that coochie dances.>

< The male strippers as well as some of the females are giving lap dances.>

< The customers are placing money all over the stripper's thin garments.>

< The stripper's collect as much money as they can. They make their way back to the

[. _ _

[...]

stage.>

< The audience wildly applauds.>

< Once they are back on stage, they begin performing exotic acts on each other.> (HOURS PASS)

< Unique emerges on the stage with the microphone.

< All the stripper's stand behind him side by side. The DJ stops the music.

< He looks out into the exhausted but eager audience.

[...]

[...

(Unique)

Well, ladies and gentlemen, I'm glad y'all enjoyed yourselves but it's time to wrap it up. It's closing time. I thank you all for making my grand opening the shit.

< All the partygoers begin to file out of the club.>

149. INT. (Club Millennium Unique's office)

< Unique is reclined behind his large Oakwood desk with his hands intertwined behind his head.>

< He looks pleased.>

< Tony and Stone enter the room.>

< A crowd of female stripper's in their tight street clothes hover around the open door.>

< Unique stands and shakes the gentlemen's hands.>

(Tony)

Congratulations, my friend. Hell, the way this turned out, I'm thinking about shutting down my hustle and opening up a few of these joints myself.

< He shakes Unique's hand again.>

< He turns and reaches out his hands and three strippers come to his side.>

< He looks over his shoulder at Unique, smiling.>

(Tony)

Call me when you get everything from tonight situated.

< He strolls out the door with his new companions. Other stripper's from the Club Rollex are still gathered around the door.>

(Stone)

You did good my man, you did good. I got something I think you'll like to see.

(Unique)
) What
is it?

(Stone)

I'll show it to you tomorrow
afternoon.

< Stone looks at his
watch.>

(Stone)

I got to go now. I'll see you
tomorrow.

(Unique)

I'll be here at the club, so call me

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[...]

[. . .

< Stone leaves with his stripper's and closes the door.>

< Unique resumes his previous position.>

< There is a knock on the door, and Unique sits up.>

(Unique)

Who is it?

(Kenny)

It's me, Kenny.

(Unique)

Come on in, it's open.

< Kenny opens the door and closes it behind himself.>

< He sits down in a chair beside his brother's desk.>

(Kenny)

I need you to put me on to some weight, or hook me up with your connect. I been holding it down in

D.C. but I need more drugs, unless you can hook me up here in New York with a few spots. My girl is having a baby and I think we'll be better off here in the city. I know you can help me set shit up here in the city.

(Unique)

Let me think about it and check some things out.

I'll let you know what I'll do when I get back from Miami.

< Unique and his brother stand and hug.>

150. INT. (Unique's townhouse – Bedroom – Morning)

< Unique briskly walks to the ringing phone from his bathroom.>

< He's soaking wet with a towel wrapped around his naked body.

< He answers the phone.>

(Unique)

Hello? Okay...use the back stairs and knock on the office door.

Okay...okay...bye.

< He hangs up the phone.>

151. INT. (Club Millennium office)

< Unique is standing in front of his built in fireplace watching the jumping flames as he sips from a glass of wine.>

< There is a knock and he looks over his shoulder to the door.>

(Unique

) Who is

[. . .

[...]

it?

[...]

[...]

(Stone)
It's
Stone.
(Unique
)
Just a second.

< He walks over to open the door, holding a halffilled champagne glass.>
< When he opens the door, his mouth falls open and he nearly drops his glass on the carpet.>
< He looks stunned. Standing beside Stone holding a suitcase is Jade.>
< A single tears escapes her eye as she moves forward and wraps her free hand around Unique.>
< He holds her close to his heart as his eyes tightly close.>

(Stone)
It took a whole lot of convincing for her to talk me into bringing her up to New York with me, but now I see it was all good. I got a plane to catch, so I'll leave you two here and be on my way.

< Stone starts walking away.>

(Unique)
Yo,
Stone.

< He never releases his grip on Jade. Neither does she.>

(Unique)
Thanks,
man.

< Stone nods affirmatively, then takes his leave.>
< Unique leads Jade into his office.>

(Jade)
All I've thought about is you (Speaking softly)

< They stand facing each other in front of the fireplace.>

(Unique)
I don't know what you did to me, but ever since I saw you, I've been going through some shit in my mind that I couldn't identify. That's why I left. Believe it or not, I know what it is that I've been feeling now.
And since I understand it, I'm willing to give it a try as long as you help me.

(Jade)
I know what it is too Unique, and yes, I'm willing to help you with it and to do all I can to make it worth your while.

[...]

[...]

< Unique glances over to the suitcase.>

(Unique)

How long are you going to be in New

York? (Jade)

[...]

[_ _

I came up here for you, so how long I'll be here is something you'll be deciding.

(Unique)

We can put your things up later.

(Jade)

Oh, those are not my things, they're yours. That's all the money you gave me. I refused to spend a dime of it until I found you. If it weren't for Shirley being at Co-Co's the night you were there, I probably never would have found anybody down there who knew you.

(Unique)

This club is mine, Jade. I like the success that it's seeing so far, and I really believe that this can take the place of my hustling in the game. I want to separate myself from all the old shit I used to do to survive. You're the one who got me thinking about this. Jade, I want you because I think I love you, and if you didn't love me the same, you wouldn't be here

< He tenderly moves a few loose hairs from her face.>

(Unique)

I want to be with you, Jade.

(Jade)

I want to be with you too, baby. I'm here, and I'm staying.

< He leans in and kisses her softly and sensually.>

< Their passion increases as they begin to undress each other.>

< She pulls his shirt back over his shoulders, leans back, and looks into her eyes.>

(Unique)

Let's begin it, and end it with this.

< She falls backward as he falls on top of her.>

< He kisses her passionately as the flames sparkle in the fireplace behind them.>

~ Fini ~

[_ _

[...]

A ROAR IN HARLEM

CREATED BY WAINSWORTH MARCELLUS HALL

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